

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

Project Name	Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow
Platform	ServiceNow
Project Type	IT Service Management (ITSM)
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Phase 1: Requirement Analysis & Planning

1(A).Business Objectives:

The main objective of this project is to automate and standardize the Incident Management lifecycle using the ServiceNow Incident Management module.

An incident is any unexpected issue that affects a user's normal work, such as a VPN problem, email issue, network failure, application error, or system access problem. The purpose of Incident Management is to restore normal service as quickly as possible and reduce the impact on business operations.

The project aims to achieve the following business objectives:

1.Automate Incident Creation

Enable support teams to create incident records quickly with all required information such as caller, description, category, urgency, service, and configuration item.

2. Standardize Incident Management

The project provides a standard process for handling incidents from creation to closure.

The lifecycle generally follows:

Incident Creation → Classification → Assignment → Investigation → Resolution → Knowledge Creation → Closure

This ensures that every incident is handled according to the same process.

3. Faster Incident Resolution

ServiceNow helps support teams manage incidents in an organized way.

Incidents can be automatically or manually assigned to the appropriate Assignment Group and support team. This reduces the time required to identify who should work on the issue.

4.Knowledge Management Integration

When a solution is available in the **Knowledge Base**, support agents can use the knowledge article to resolve incidents faster.

For example:

If a user has a VPN authentication problem, the agent can search for a VPN troubleshooting article, follow the instructions, and attach the article to the incident.

After resolving a recurring issue, a new knowledge article can also be created so that the same solution can be reused in the future.

5.Support Incident Reassignment

Sometimes the Service Desk team cannot resolve an incident.

In such cases, the incident can be reassigned to another appropriate support group or Level 2 team.

For example:

Service Desk → Network Team → Level 2 Support

This provides a structured escalation process.

The objective of this project is to automate and standardize the Incident Management lifecycle using ServiceNow's Incident module.

6. Improve Incident Classification

Ensure that incidents are properly classified using fields such as:

- Category
- Subcategory
- Urgency
- Service
- Service Offering
- Configuration Item

Accurate classification helps the incident reach the correct support team quickly.

7. Improve Escalation Process

Provide a clear process for transferring incidents from the Service Desk to specialized Level 2 support teams.

For example, a VPN-related issue can be escalated to the **Network** team for further investigation.

This ensures that technical issues are handled by the appropriate team.

8. Integrate Change Management

Allow incidents that require infrastructure or service changes to be connected with an appropriate **Change Request**.

For emergency situations, an **Emergency Change Request** can be created and linked to the incident.

This provides proper authorization, tracking, and documentation of changes.

9. Improve Knowledge Management

Create Knowledge Articles from resolved incidents so that solutions can be reused for similar problems in the future.

For example, the solution for a Corporate VPN issue can be documented in the **IT Knowledge Base**.

10. Monitor SLA Performance

Track Service Level Agreements (SLAs) related to incidents to help support teams monitor response and resolution timelines.

11. Improve Overall Service Delivery

Provide a structured and transparent incident lifecycle that improves communication between support teams, reduces manual work, and helps deliver consistent IT support.

This helps Service Desk agents resolve recurring incidents more quickly.

Key goals include:

Enable Service Desk agents to create and classify incidents.
Integrate Knowledge Management for faster resolution.
Allow reassignment to appropriate support groups.
Enable Level 2 technicians to investigate and resolve incidents.
Create emergency change requests directly from incidents.
Allow child incident creation for tracking recurring issues.
Generate knowledge articles from resolved incidents.
Improve SLA compliance and service visibility.

1(B).Functional Scope:

The functional scope of this project covers the complete Incident Management lifecycle, starting from incident creation and classification and continuing through investigation, resolution, knowledge creation, and SLA tracking.

1. Incident Record Creation in Service Operations Workspace

The system allows Service Desk agents to create and manage incident records from the Service Operations Workspace.

When a user reports an issue, the agent creates an incident and enters important information such as:

- Caller
- Short Description
- Description

- Channel
- Category
- Subcategory
- Impact
- Urgency
- Service
- Configuration Item (CI)
- Assignment Group
- Assigned To

2. Agent Assist Knowledge Integration

The project integrates **Agent Assist with Knowledge Management**.

When an agent opens an incident, Agent Assist can recommend relevant Knowledge Articles based on the incident's information, especially the short description.

The agent can:

1. Open Agent Assist.
2. View recommended Knowledge Articles.
3. Open a suitable article.
4. Mark the article as **Helpful** if it provides a useful solution.
5. Attach the article to the incident.
6. Add a comment describing how the article should be used.

3. Reassignment to Level 2 Support Teams

If the Service Desk cannot resolve the incident, it can be reassigned or escalated to a **Level 2 Support Team**.

For example:

Service Desk → Network Support → Level 2 Support

The assignment information can include:

- Assignment Group
- Assigned To
- Work Notes
- Additional Comments

The agent can document why the incident is being reassigned.

4. Incident Creation

The system allows Service Desk agents to create a new incident when a user reports an IT issue.

The incident record captures important information such as:

- Caller
- Short Description
- Description
- Contact/Channel
- Category
- Subcategory

- Urgency
- Service
- Service Offering
- Configuration Item

Each incident receives a unique Incident Number for tracking.

5. Incident Classification

The system allows agents to classify incidents based on the type and impact of the issue.

For the VPN scenario, the incident can be classified as:

- **Category:** Network
- **Subcategory:** VPN
- **Urgency:** 2 - Medium
- **Service:** Remote Access
- **Service Offering:** Corporate VPN
- **Configuration Item:** PowerEdge

Proper classification helps the support team understand the issue and route it to the correct team.

6. Knowledge Integration

The system provides access to Knowledge Articles through **Agent Assist**.

Agents can:

- Search for relevant Knowledge Articles.
- Open an article.
- Mark an article as Helpful.
- Attach an article to the incident.
- Add comments related to the suggested solution.

This helps agents resolve common incidents faster.

7. Incident Classification

Incidents are classified using fields such as **Category, Subcategory, Urgency, Service, Service Offering, and Configuration Item**.

Purpose:

Proper classification helps support teams understand the issue quickly and route the incident to the appropriate team.

8. Reassignment and Escalation

When the Service Desk cannot resolve an incident, the incident can be reassigned to the appropriate **Level 2 Support Group**. Work notes and activity information are maintained during the handover.

9. Emergency Change Request Creation

For incidents that require an urgent technical change, an **Emergency Change Request** can be created and associated with the incident.

10. Knowledge Article Creation

After resolving an incident, useful resolution information can be converted into a **Knowledge Article** and stored in the appropriate Knowledge Base.

The functional scope includes:

Incident Record Creation in Service Operations Workspace.
Incident Classification (Category, Subcategory, Urgency, Service, CI).
Agent Assist Knowledge Integration.
Reassignment to Level 2 Support Teams.
Emergency Change Request Creation.
Child Incident Creation.
Incident Cause & Resolution Documentation.
Knowledge Article Creation from Incident.
SLA and Related Record Tracking.

1(c). Stakeholder Mapping:**Objective:**

Stakeholder Mapping is the process of identifying the people, teams, and roles involved in the **Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow** project.

Each stakeholder has different responsibilities during the incident lifecycle. Identifying them helps ensure that the system meets business requirements and supports effective communication and collaboration.

1.End Users/Employees**Role:**

End users are employees or customers who experience IT-related problems and report them to the Service Desk.

End users report incidents when they face issues such as VPN connection problems, application errors, hardware failures, or network issues. They provide the required information about the problem and confirm whether the issue has been resolved.

Examples:

- Cannot connect to VPN
- Email is not working
- Laptop is not connecting to the network
- Application is not accessible
- Password or authentication problem

2. Service Desk Agents**Role:**

Service Desk Agents are the **first level of support**. They receive issues from end users, create incidents, classify them, and try to resolve them.

Their activities include:

1. Create incident
2. Enter caller and issue details
3. Classify the incident
4. Set urgency and priority
5. Check Knowledge Articles
6. Troubleshoot the issue
7. Assign or escalate the incident when required
8. Update work notes
9. Resolve the incident

3. Stakeholders Identified

The main stakeholders involved in this project are:

1. End User / Caller
2. Service Desk Agent
3. Level 2 Support Team
4. Change Management Team
5. Knowledge Management Team
6. ServiceNow Administrator
7. Project Manager / IT Management

4. Stakeholder Details:**4.1 End User / Caller**

The End User is the person who experiences the IT issue and reports the incident.

Responsibilities:

- Report the IT issue.
- Provide information about the problem.
- Respond to questions from the Service Desk.
- Confirm whether the issue has been resolved.

Project Requirement:

The user should be able to report an incident and receive appropriate support until the issue is resolved.

4.2 Service Desk Agent

The Service Desk Agent is responsible for the initial handling of the incident.

Responsibilities:

- Create the incident.
- Enter caller and issue details.
- Classify the incident.
- Set category, subcategory, urgency, service, and CI.
- Search Knowledge Articles.
- Add Work Notes.
- Assign or escalate the incident to the appropriate support team.

- Monitor the incident until resolution.

Project Requirement:

The Service Desk Agent should be able to manage the incident efficiently from creation through escalation.

4.3 Level 2 Support Team

Level 2 Support handles incidents that require specialized technical knowledge.

For the VPN scenario, the **Network Team** can investigate the issue.

Responsibilities:

- Receive escalated incidents.
- Investigate technical problems.
- Identify the probable cause.
- Perform troubleshooting.
- Provide or implement the required solution.
- Update Work Notes and resolution details.

Project Requirement:

The system should allow incidents to be reassigned to specialized teams when first-level support cannot resolve them.

4.4 Change Management Team

The Change Management Team manages changes required to restore or modify IT services.

Responsibilities:

- Review change requests.
- Handle emergency changes when required.
- Ensure appropriate approval and implementation processes.
- Track the change associated with the incident.
- Maintain change records.

Project Requirement:

The system should support integration between **Incident Management and Change Management** so that required changes can be linked to the incident.

4.5 Knowledge Management Team

The Knowledge Management Team is responsible for maintaining reusable support information.

The Knowledge Management team manages Knowledge Articles. When a useful solution is identified during incident resolution, the solution can be converted into a Knowledge Article for future use.

Responsibilities:

- Create Knowledge Articles.
- Review technical solutions.
- Maintain Knowledge Base content.
- Make useful solutions available to support agents.
- Help reduce repeated troubleshooting.

Project Requirement:

Resolved incidents should provide useful information that can be converted into Knowledge Articles.

4.6 ServiceNow Administrator

The ServiceNow Administrator configures the platform, workflows, forms, SLAs, related records, notifications, and integrations required for incident lifecycle automation.

Responsibilities:

- Configure Incident Management.
- Configure users and roles.
- Maintain Assignment Groups.
- Configure Services and Service Offerings.
- Maintain Configuration Items.
- Configure Knowledge Management.
- Configure SLAs.
- Support Change Management integration.
- Troubleshoot configuration issues.

Project Requirement:

The administrator should ensure that all required ServiceNow modules and configurations are available for the incident lifecycle.

4.7 Project Manager / IT Management

Project or IT Management provides overall direction and monitors project performance.

Responsibilities:

- Define project objectives.

- Review project requirements.
- Monitor SLA performance.
- Review incident trends.
- Ensure the solution meets business expectations.
- Approve project completion and deployment.

Project Requirement:

Management should have sufficient visibility into incident status, SLA performance, resolution, and service delivery.

5. Level 2 Support Teams

Role:

Level 2 teams handle incidents that cannot be resolved by the Service Desk.

Examples include:

- Network Team
- Hardware Team
- Application Support Team
- Infrastructure Team

They perform detailed technical investigation and provide the final solution.

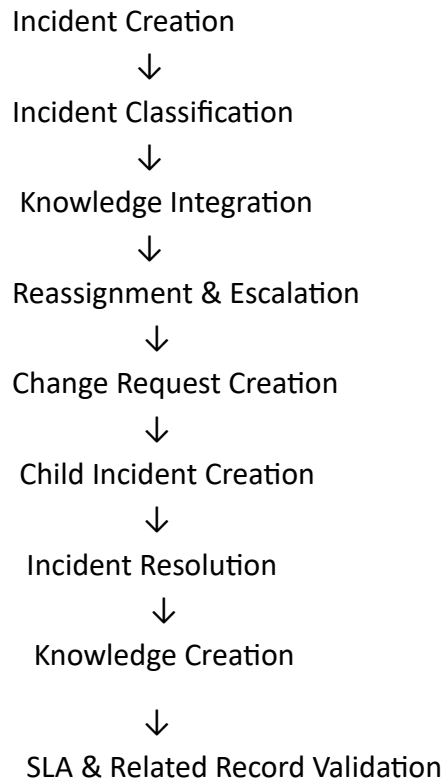
Stakeholder	Role	Needs / Expectations	Impact of Automation
End Users	Report IT issues	Quick resolution, visibility	✓ Faster issue resolution ✓ Transparent tracking
Service Desk Agents	First-level support	Easy logging, classification tools	✓ Standardized intake ✓ Faster escalation
Level 2 Support (Network/Hardware Teams)	Diagnose & resolve issues	Complete incident data, related records	✓ Better diagnosis ✓ Clear task ownership
Change Management Team	Handle emergency changes	Structured change requests	✓ Integrated change control
ServiceNow Admin	Maintain configuration	Scalable and trackable solution	✓ Controlled process management

1(d).Execution Roadmap:

The execution roadmap is divided into different milestones. Each milestone represents an important stage of the Incident Management lifecycle.

The Execution Roadmap defines the step-by-step plan for developing and implementing the Incident Lifecycle Automation project in ServiceNow. It helps ensure that all required features are completed in the correct order and properly tested.

Overall Project Flow:



1. Incident Record Creation

The first milestone is to create an incident record in Service Operations Workspace.

The Service Desk agent enters information such as:

- Caller
- Short Description
- Description
- Contact/Channel
- Category
- Subcategory
- Urgency
- Service
- Configuration Item
- Assignment Group

2. Incident Classification

After creating the incident, the agent classifies it correctly.

Important fields include:

- Category
- Subcategory
- Impact
- Urgency
- Priority
- Service
- Service Offering
- Configuration Item (CI)

Example:

A VPN authentication problem can be classified as:

Category: Network

Subcategory: VPN

Urgency: 2 - Medium

Service: Remote Access

Service Offering: Corporate VPN

3. Knowledge Integration

At this stage, the agent uses Agent Assist to find relevant Knowledge Articles.

The agent can:

1. Open Agent Assist.
2. View recommended Knowledge Articles.
3. Open an article.
4. Mark it as Helpful.
5. Attach the article to the incident.
6. Add appropriate comments.

4. Reassignment & Escalation

If the Service Desk cannot resolve the incident, it is reassigned to the appropriate Level 2 Support Team.

For example:

Service Desk → Network Team → Level 2 Support

The agent updates:

- Assignment Group
- Assigned To
- Work Notes
- Incident State

5. Change Request Creation

If resolving the incident requires a system or configuration change, create an appropriate

Change Request and associate it with the incident. This helps ensure that changes are properly tracked and managed.

6. Child Incident Creation

When the same issue affects multiple users or requires separate tracking, create a **Child Incident** under the parent incident. This helps manage related issues efficiently.

7. Incident Resolution

Identify the cause of the incident and perform the required resolution steps. Update the **Probable Cause, Resolution Code, and Resolution Notes**, and then move the incident to the **Resolved** state.

8. Knowledge Creation

If the resolved incident provides useful information for future incidents, create a **Knowledge Article** from the incident. Select the appropriate Knowledge Base and save the article for future reference.

9. SLA & Related Record Validation

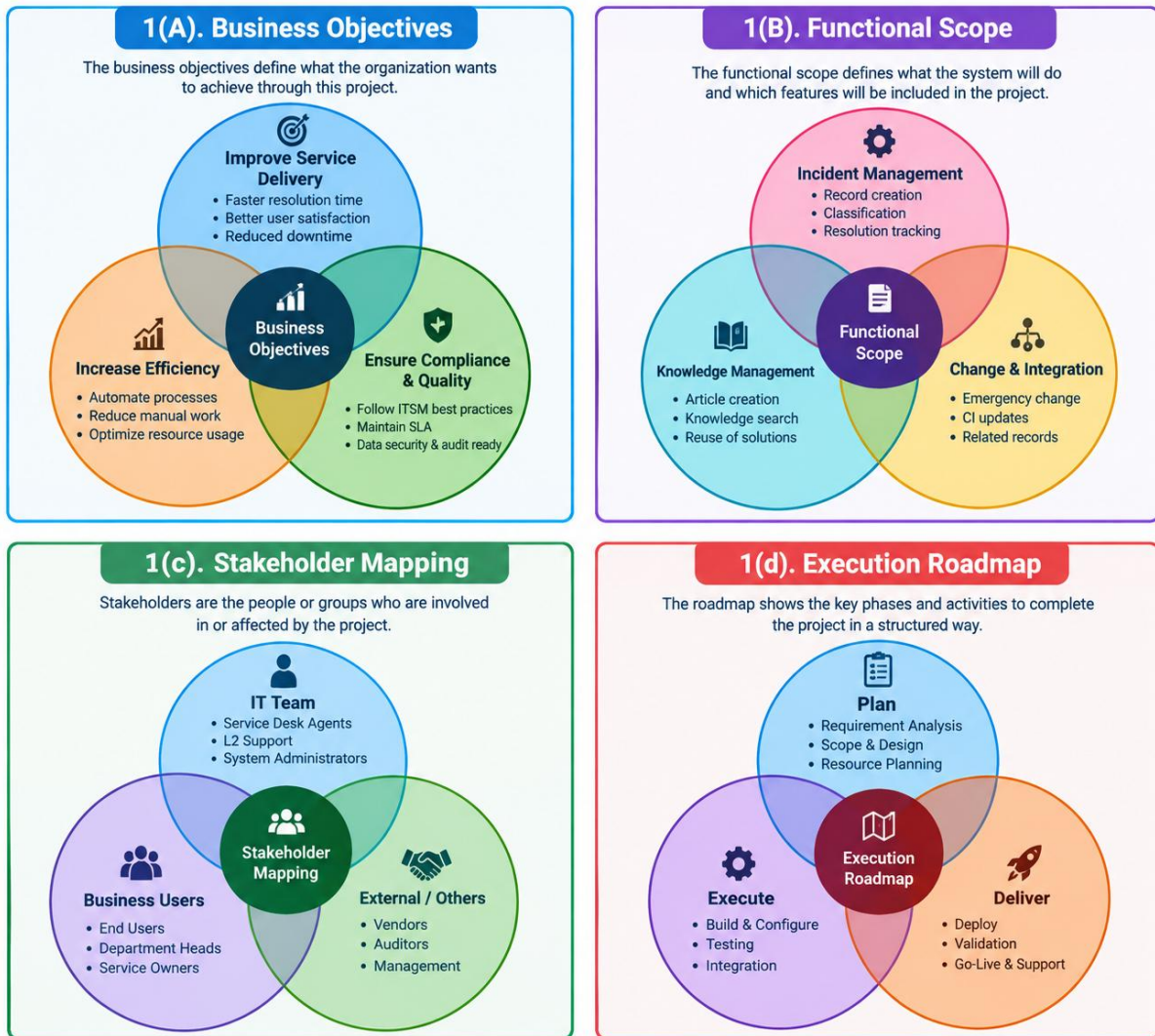
Finally, verify the incident's **SLA information and related records**. Confirm that the parent incident, child incident, change request, knowledge article, and activity history are correctly linked and updated.

Milestones:

Incident Record Creation
Incident Classification
Knowledge Integration
Reassignment & Escalation
Change Request Creation
Child Incident Creation
Incident Resolution
Knowledge Creation
SLA & Related Record Validation

Skills:

Incident Management
Agent Assist
Change Management Integration
Related Lists
SLAs
Knowledge Management.



Phase 2: Create New Service, Service Offering

2(A). Milestone 1: Create New Service

Objective

The objective of this step is to create a new service called Remote Access in ServiceNow.

A Service represents an IT service provided to users or the organization. In your project, Remote Access represents services such as VPN or remote connectivity that employees use to access company resources.

Once created, this service can later be selected in an Incident record.

Steps to Create a New Service

Step 1: Open the ServiceNow Instance

Log in to your ServiceNow instance using an account that has the required admin or appropriate configuration permissions.

You should be on the main ServiceNow interface.

Step 2: Open "All"

From the left-side navigation menu:

1. Click All.
2. The Application Navigator will open.
3. Use the search box to find the required module/table.

Step 3: Search for the Service Table

In the All search box, enter: cmdb_ci_service.list

This opens the list of records from the Service [cmdb_ci_service] table.

Step 4: Click "New"

After the Service list opens:

1. Click New.
2. A new Service form will appear.
3. This form is used to enter the details of the service.

Step 5: Enter the Service Name

In the Name field, enter:

Remote Access

The name identifies the service that will be used in your Incident Management process.

Step 6: Set Operational Status

Find the Operational status field.

Select:Operational

This indicates that the Remote Access service is currently active and available for use.

Step 7: Verify the Details

After entering the service information, verify that all the details are correct before submitting the record.

After verifying all the details, click Submit to create the service.

Before submitting, verify that the information is correct:

Field	Value
Name	Remote Access

Field	Value
-------	-------

Operational status Operational

If your instance displays additional mandatory fields, complete those fields according to your project's requirements.

Step 8: Click Submit

After verifying the information, click Submit.

ServiceNow will create the Remote Access service and return you to the service list.

You should now be able to find Remote Access in the list of services.

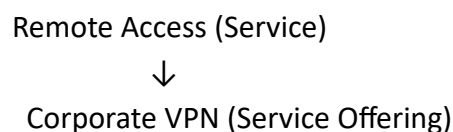
2(B). Milestone 2: Create New Service Offering:

Objective

The Service Offering represents a specific service provided to users under a parent service. In this project, we create Corporate VPN as a service offering under the Remote Access service. This helps in correctly identifying and classifying VPN-related incidents.

The objective of this step is to create a **Corporate VPN Service Offering** and associate it with the previously created **Remote Access** service.

The relationship will be:



This is useful in your Incident Management project because VPN-related incidents can be associated specifically with the **Corporate VPN** offering.

Steps to Create a New Service Offering

Step 1: Open ServiceNow

Log in to your ServiceNow instance using an account with the required **admin or configuration permissions**.

Step 2: Click "All"

From the left-side navigation:

1. Click **All**.
2. The **Application Navigator** will appear.
3. Use the search box to find the Service Offering table.

Step 3: Search for Service Offering

In the Application Navigator search box, enter: `service_offering.list`

This opens the list of Service Offering records.

Depending on your ServiceNow version, you may also find this through the **Service Catalog/CMDB or Service Portfolio** modules.

Step 4: Click "New"

After the Service Offering list opens:

1. Click **New**.
2. A new Service Offering form will appear.
3. Enter the required information.

Step 5: Enter the Name

In the **Name** field, enter:

Corporate VPN

This identifies the specific service offering.

Step 6: Select the Parent Service

In the **Parent** field, select:

Remote Access

This establishes the relationship between the Service Offering and the Service created in the previous milestone.

So the hierarchy becomes:

Service: Remote Access

Service Offering: Corporate VPN

Step 7: Set Operational Status

In the **Operational status** field, select:

Operational

This indicates that the Corporate VPN service offering is currently active and available for use.

Step 8: Verify the Details

Before submitting, check the following:

Field	Value
Name	Corporate VPN
Parent	Remote Access
Operational Status	Operational

If your instance has other mandatory fields, complete them as required.

Make sure the **Corporate VPN** Service Offering is correctly linked to the **Remote Access** parent service and the status is set to **Operational**. After confirming the details, click **Submit** to create the Service Offering.

Step 9: Click Submit

After entering all the required Service Offering details, the final step is to save the record in ServiceNow.

Step-by-Step Process

1. Review all the entered information before submitting the form.
2. Verify the following details:

Field	Expected Value
Name	Corporate VPN
Parent Service	Remote Access
Operational Status	Operational

3. Click the **Submit** button.
4. ServiceNow saves the new Service Offering record.
5. The system returns to the Service Offering list or the newly created record, depending on the instance configuration.

6. Search for **Corporate VPN** and verify that the Service Offering has been created successfully.

After verifying all details, click **Submit**.

ServiceNow will create the **Corporate VPN** Service Offering.

Offering Corporate VPN

Name: Corporate VPN

Model ID: [Search]

Owned by: [Search]

* Parent: Remote Access [Search]

Used for: Production [Dropdown]

Operational status: Operational [Dropdown]

Vendor: [Search]

Approval group: [Search]

Support group: [Search]

Change group: [Search]

Managed by: [Search]

Version: [Text]

Business criticality: 2 - somewhat critical [Dropdown]

SLA: [Search]

Location: [Search]

Short Description: [Text]

Description: [Text]

Comments: [Text]

Related Items: [Icons] Show 3 Levels [Dropdown]

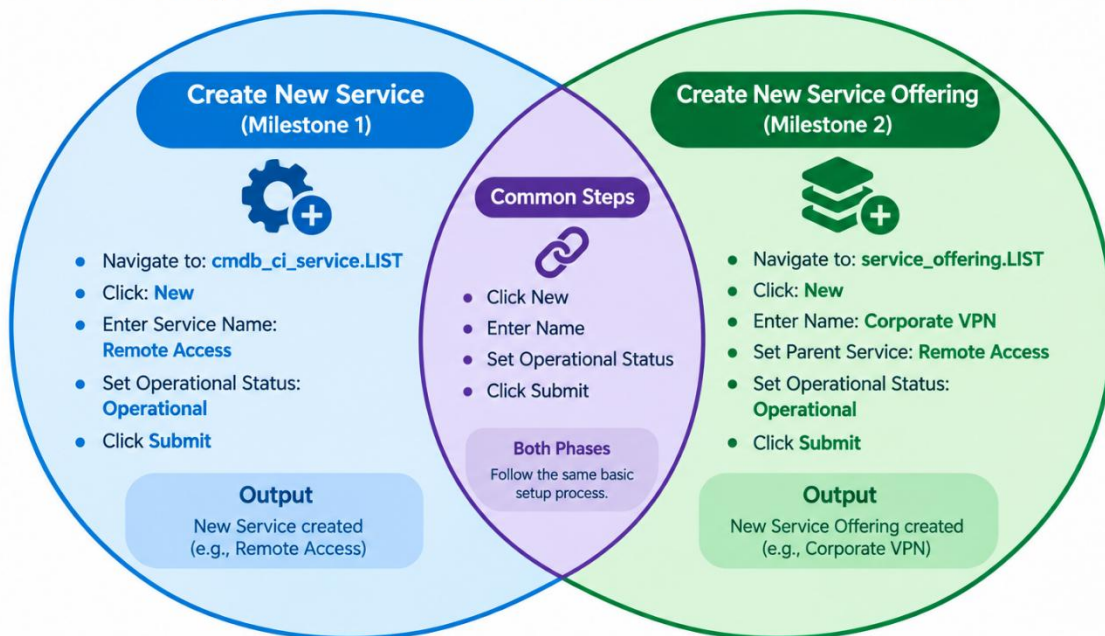
Contract: [Search]

Open in CMDB Workspace Update Delete

Related Links
Subscribe

Phase 2: Create New Service, Service Offering

In this phase, we create a new service and then create a service offering for that service.



Phase 3: Incident Record Creation

3(A).Creating Incident Record:

Objective

The objective is to create an incident record for a user who is unable to connect to the **Corporate VPN from their home office**.

The incident will be created in **Service Operations Workspace** and will later be used for classification, Knowledge integration, escalation, SLA tracking, and resolution.

Incident Record Creation is the first step in the Incident Management process. In this step, a new incident is created in ServiceNow to record and track a user's reported issue.

Step-by-Step Process

Step 1: Open ServiceNow

Open your ServiceNow instance and log in.

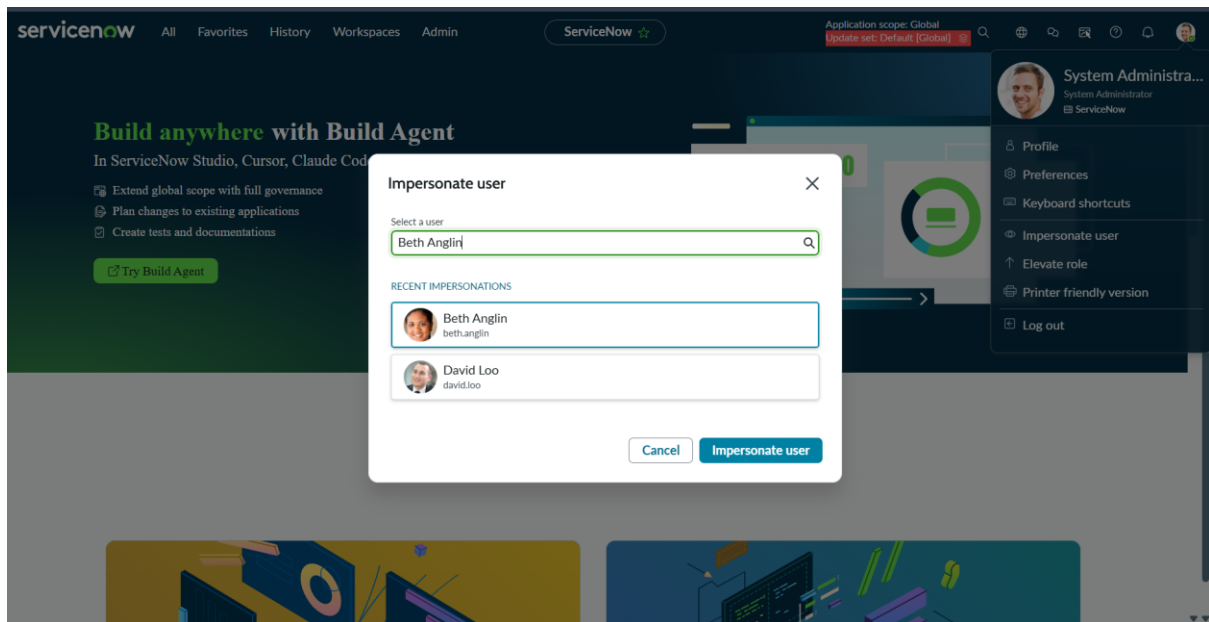
You should be on the main ServiceNow interface.

Step 2: Impersonate Beth Anglin

Before creating the incident, impersonate **Beth Anglin**.

1. Open the user/profile menu in ServiceNow.
2. Select **Impersonate User**.
3. Search for **Beth Anglin**.
4. Select **Beth Anglin**.
5. Confirm the impersonation.

You are now working in ServiceNow as Beth Anglin.



Step 3: Open Service Operations Workspace

Open Service Operations Workspace in ServiceNow to begin creating and managing the incident.

- Log in to the ServiceNow instance with the required user account.
- From the main navigation, open Service Operations Workspace.
- Select Incidents from the workspace menu.
- Click Open to view the list of existing incidents.
- Verify that the incident list is displayed correctly.
- Click New to start creating a new incident record.

Navigate to:

Service Operations Workspace → List → Incidents → Open

This opens the list of currently open incidents.

Step 4: Click "New"

On the Incidents list:

1. Click **New**.
2. ServiceNow opens a new Incident form.
3. You can now enter the incident information.

Step 5: Enter the Short Description

Find the **Short description** field.

Enter: **Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office**

The short description provides a quick summary of the user's problem.

It should be clear and concise so that support agents can immediately understand the issue.

Step 6: Select the Caller

The Caller field identifies the user who reported the incident.

In the **Caller** field, select the user who reported the incident. For this project, select **Michael Hoefer** as the caller. Verify that the correct user is selected before proceeding with the remaining incident details.

Find the **Caller** field.

Search for:

Michael Hoefer

Select **Michael Hoefer** from the available users.

The Caller represents the user who reported or is experiencing the problem.

Therefore: **Caller = Michael Hoefer**

Step 7: Verify the Information

Before saving, verify:

Field	Value
Short description	Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office
Caller	Michael Hoefer
Incident Number	Automatically generated by ServiceNow after saving

Other fields may be automatically populated by ServiceNow or may become available for you to complete later during the classification stage.

Step 8: Click "Save"

Click **Save**.

ServiceNow creates the incident record and assigns it a unique **Incident Number**, such as: **INC0010057**

The exact incident number will be generated by your ServiceNow instance.

Important: Note down the generated incident number because you will use it for the next steps of your project.

Expected Result

A new incident record is successfully created with the required **Short Description** and **Caller** information. The generated incident number can be used to track the issue throughout its lifecycle.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for an incident record. The top navigation bar includes 'List', 'INC0010064', and 'Service Operations Workspace'. The incident title is 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office'. The 'Save' button is highlighted in green. The 'Details' tab is active, showing the 'Impact' section with a 'Business Impact' field. The 'Assignment' section shows the 'Assignment group' as 'Service Desk' and the 'Assigned to' field. The 'Related Records' section includes fields for 'Parent Incident', 'Change Request', 'Problem', and 'Caused by Change'. The 'Activity' section shows a comment by 'Beth Anglin' with details: Impact 3 - Low, Incident state New, Opened by Beth Anglin, and Priority 5 - Planning. The 'Record Information' section shows the last update by Beth Anglin on 2026-09-18 23:33:34, SLAs and timings (Response SLA 06d 12h, Resolution SLA No matching SLA), and the caller 'Michael Hoefer' from Development in Brasilia.

Phase 4: Incident Classification

4(A).Updating Incident Details:

Objective

The purpose of this step is to provide complete information about the VPN issue, classify the incident correctly, associate it with the appropriate service and configuration item, and assign the incident to yourself for further investigation.

In this step, the incident details are updated to **classify the issue correctly**. Proper classification helps the support team understand the problem, identify the affected service, and route the incident to the appropriate team.

Step-by-Step Process

Step 1: Stay in the Same Incident

After creating the incident in the previous step, **do not create a new incident**.

Open the incident that you created for:

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Make sure the **Caller** is: **Michael Hoefer**

Step 2: Open the Details Tab

On the incident form, select the **Details** tab.

The Details section contains the fields required to describe and classify the incident.

Step 3: Update the Description

Find the **Description** field and enter:

Michael advised he was able to connect yesterday evening, but this morning received an authentication error. The Internet works fine.

This information helps the support team investigate the issue.

Step 4: Set Channel

Find the **Channel** field and select: **Phone**

This indicates that Michael reported the issue through a phone call.

Purpose:

It records how the incident was reported.

Step 5: Set Category

Find **Category** and select:

Network

The incident is related to network/remote connectivity.

Purpose:

Category provides the high-level classification of the incident.

Step 6: Set Subcategory

Find **Subcategory** and select:

VPN

This gives a more specific classification under the Network category.

The classification is therefore:

Category → Network

Subcategory → VPN

This makes it easier for support teams to identify the technical area involved.

Step 7: Set Urgency

Find the **Urgency** field and select:

2 - Medium

Urgency represents how quickly the issue needs attention.

Here, the incident is considered **Medium urgency**.

ServiceNow may use urgency together with **Impact** to determine the incident's priority, depending on your instance configuration.

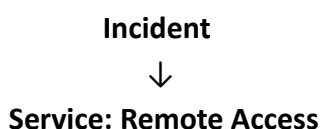
Step 8: Select the Service

Find the **Service** field and select:

Remote Access

This connects the incident to the **Remote Access** service that you created earlier.

The relationship is:



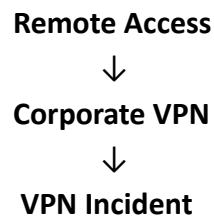
Step 9: Select the Service Offering

Find **Service Offering** and select:

Corporate VPN

This connects the incident to the specific service offering created earlier.

The hierarchy is now:



This provides more specific information about which service is affected.

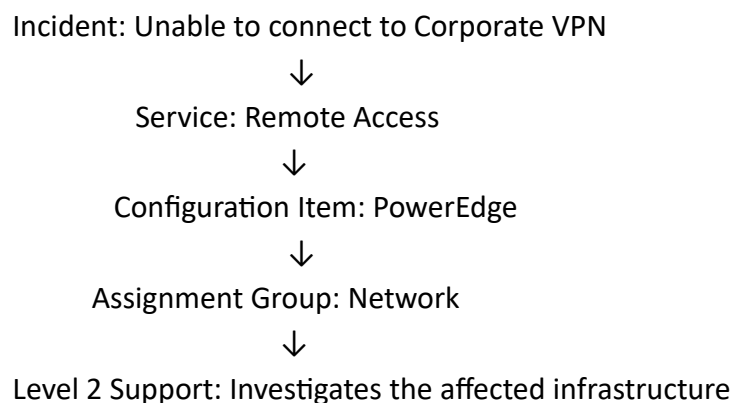
Step 10: Select the Configuration Item

In the Configuration Item (CI) field, select the configuration item affected by the incident.

Role in Reassignment & Escalation

The Configuration Item provides important technical context before an incident is reassigned or escalated.

For example:



This allows the support team receiving the **incident to understand the technical area involved before beginning investigation.**

Find the **Configuration Item (CI)** field.

Select: **ThinkStationS20**

If your instance provides different available Configuration Items, select **any one appropriate available CI**, as specified in your project instructions.

A Configuration Item represents an IT component such as a:

- Computer
- Server
- Network device
- Application
- Database

Purpose:

Associating a CI helps the support team identify the IT asset related to the incident.

Step 11: Add Work Notes

Work Notes are used to record important internal updates and actions performed by the support team during incident investigation and escalation.

In this project, after reviewing and classifying the VPN incident, the agent adds a work note to document the current action before assigning the incident to the appropriate support team.

Work Notes:

Classified and assigned incident.

The work note provides a clear history of what was done to the incident. It helps other support team members understand the progress and actions already performed.

Purpose

Adding Work Notes helps to:

- Maintain an internal activity history.
- Communicate important updates between support teams.
- Document investigation and escalation activities.
- Avoid repeating the same troubleshooting steps.
- Improve incident tracking and collaboration.

Go to the **Compose** section.

Find **Work notes** and enter:

Classified and assigned incident.

Work notes are internal notes used by support teams to record actions and investigation details.

Purpose:

This documents that the incident has been classified and assigned for further processing.

Step 12: Click "Assign to Me"

Click the Assign to Me button on the Incident form to assign the incident to the current logged-in user.

Click:**Assign to me**

This assigns the incident to the currently logged-in/impersonated user.

The **Assigned to** field should now show the appropriate user.

- The **Assigned to** field is automatically populated with your user name.
- You become responsible for working on the incident.
- The incident remains associated with the selected **Assignment Group**.
- Verify that the correct user name appears in the **Assigned to** field.
- Click **Save** to save the updated assignment.

Purpose:

It establishes clear ownership of the incident so that someone is responsible for investigating and resolving it.

Step 13: Save the Incident

After completing all the fields, review the information and click **Save**.

The incident will be updated with the new classification, service information, configuration item, and assignment.

After updating the **Assignment Group** and other required incident details, review the information entered in the incident record.

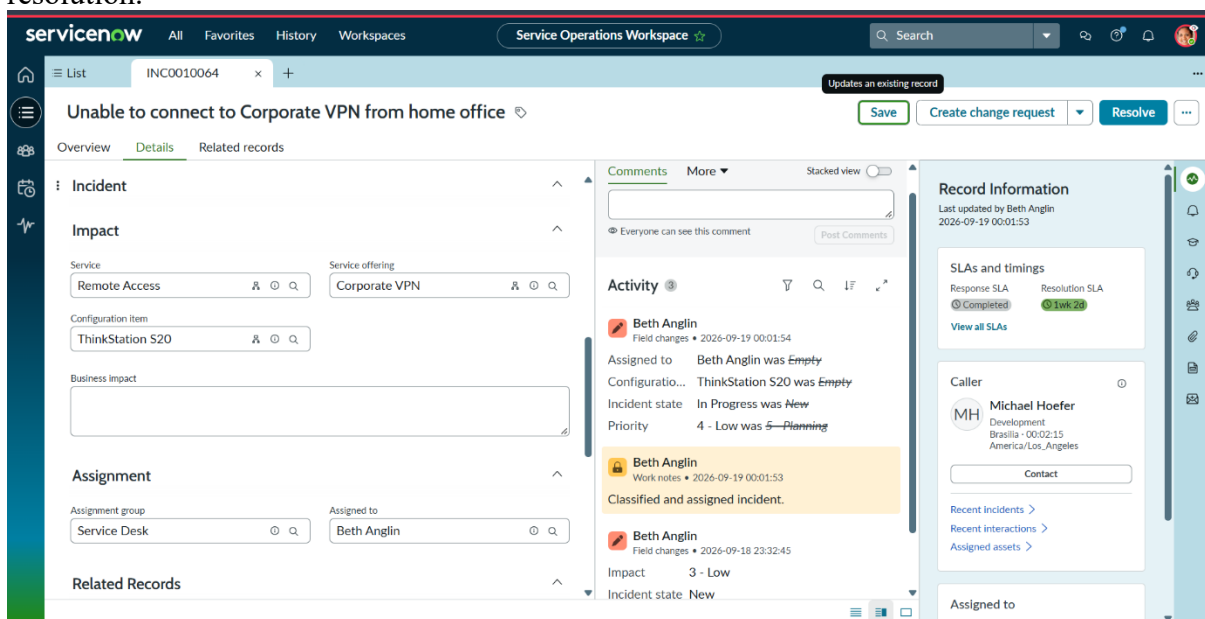
Click the **Save** button to save the changes.

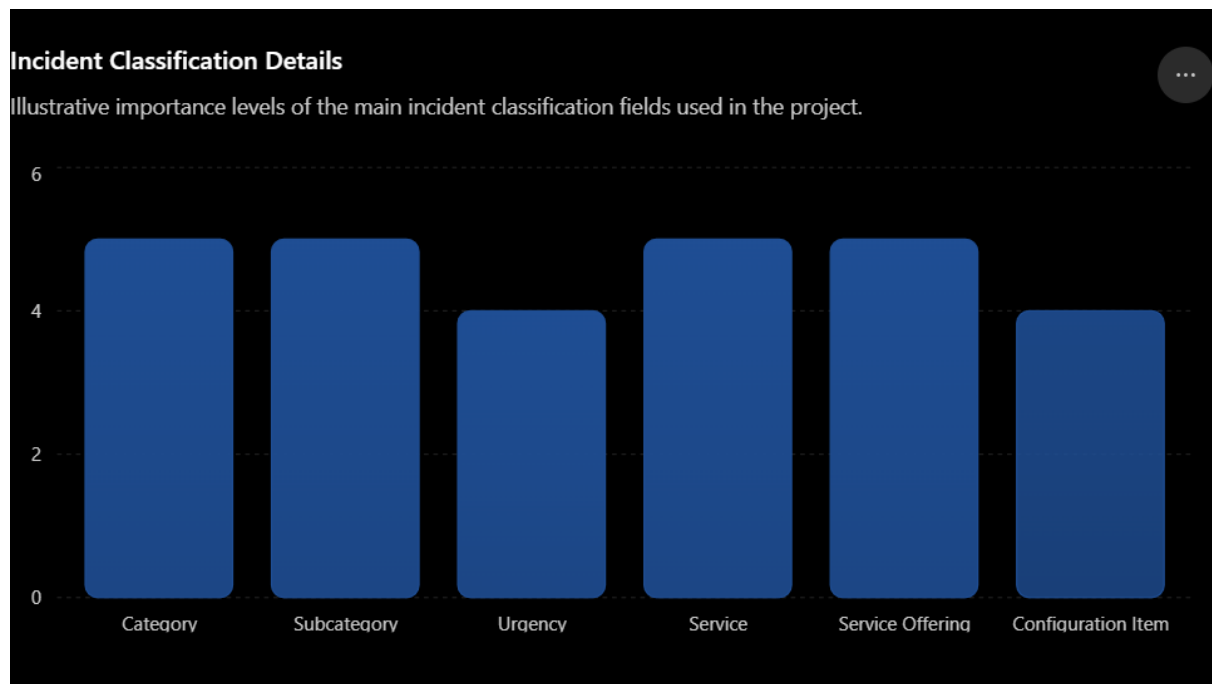
After saving, verify that:

- The selected **Assignment Group** is displayed correctly.
- The incident remains associated with the correct parent record.
- The updated incident information is saved successfully.
- The incident is available to the assigned support team for further investigation and resolution.
- Saving the incident ensures that the reassignment and escalation details are recorded in ServiceNow and can be tracked throughout the incident lifecycle.

Expected Result:

The incident is successfully saved and reassigned to the appropriate support team for further resolution.





Phase 5: Knowledge Integration

5(A).Agent Assist Verification:

Objective

The objective of this step is to use **Agent Assist** to find relevant Knowledge Articles based on the incident's short description.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for an incident record. The incident title is "Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office". The incident details include Service: Remote Access, Service offering: Corporate VPN, Configuration Item: ThinkStation S20, and Business impact. The Assignment section shows the Assignment group as Service Desk and Assigned to as Beth Anglin. The Agent Assist sidebar is open, displaying a search bar with the incident title and a list of knowledge articles. The "Knowledge Articles" option is highlighted in the sidebar menu.

For your incident, the short description is:

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Agent Assist helps the support agent find relevant troubleshooting information without manually searching the entire Knowledge Base.

Step-by-Step Process

Step 1: Stay in the Same Incident

Open the incident you created and classified in the previous step.

Verify that the incident is:

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Do not create a new incident.

Step 2: Open Agent Assist

On the **right-side panel** of the incident form, locate:

Agent Assist

Click **Agent Assist**.

Agent Assist opens a panel that provides additional assistance to the agent while working on the incident.

Step 3: Select Knowledge Articles

Inside Agent Assist, make sure:

Knowledge Articles

is selected.

This tells Agent Assist to search for relevant Knowledge Articles related to the incident.

Step 4: Verify Recommended Articles

Agent Assist should display Knowledge Articles that are relevant to the incident.

The recommendations are based on information from the incident, especially the **Short Description**.

Your short description is:

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Therefore, you may see articles related to:

- VPN
- VPN authentication
- Remote access

- Corporate VPN
- VPN troubleshooting
- Authentication errors

The exact articles displayed can vary depending on the Knowledge Base and data available in your ServiceNow instance.

Step 5: Open a Knowledge Article

From the recommended articles:

1. Select any relevant Knowledge Article.
2. Open the article.
3. Read the troubleshooting instructions.
4. Check whether the article provides steps that can help resolve the VPN issue.

For your project, choose an article that is related to the **VPN/authentication problem** if one is available.

Step 6: Mark the Article as Helpful

Inside the Knowledge Article:

1. Locate the **three dots (:)** menu.
2. Click the three dots.

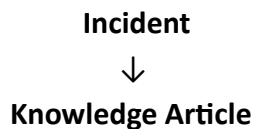
Step 7: Attach the Knowledge Article

After reviewing the article, select:

Attach Article

This associates the Knowledge Article with the current incident.

The relationship is now:



This makes it easier for other support agents to understand which knowledge was used during incident resolution.

Step 8: Enter the Comment

When the Attach Article option asks for a comment, enter:

Follow the Steps and Resolve the Incident.

This comment explains the action that should be taken using the attached Knowledge Article.

Step 9: Select Attach Article

After entering the comment:

1. Verify the comment.
2. Click **Attach Article**.

The article should now be associated with the incident.

Step 10: Return to the Incident

Return to the main incident record.

Check the **Activity** section of the incident.

You should be able to see that the Knowledge Article was attached or referenced in the incident activity.

Step 11: Verify Knowledge Article in Activity Log

Look at the **Activity Log / Activity** section.

Verify that the Knowledge Article attachment is recorded.

This confirms that the agent used Knowledge Management while working on the incident.

Step 12: Verify Helpful Indicator

The purpose of verifying the Helpful Indicator is to confirm that the selected Knowledge Article was useful for resolving the incident.

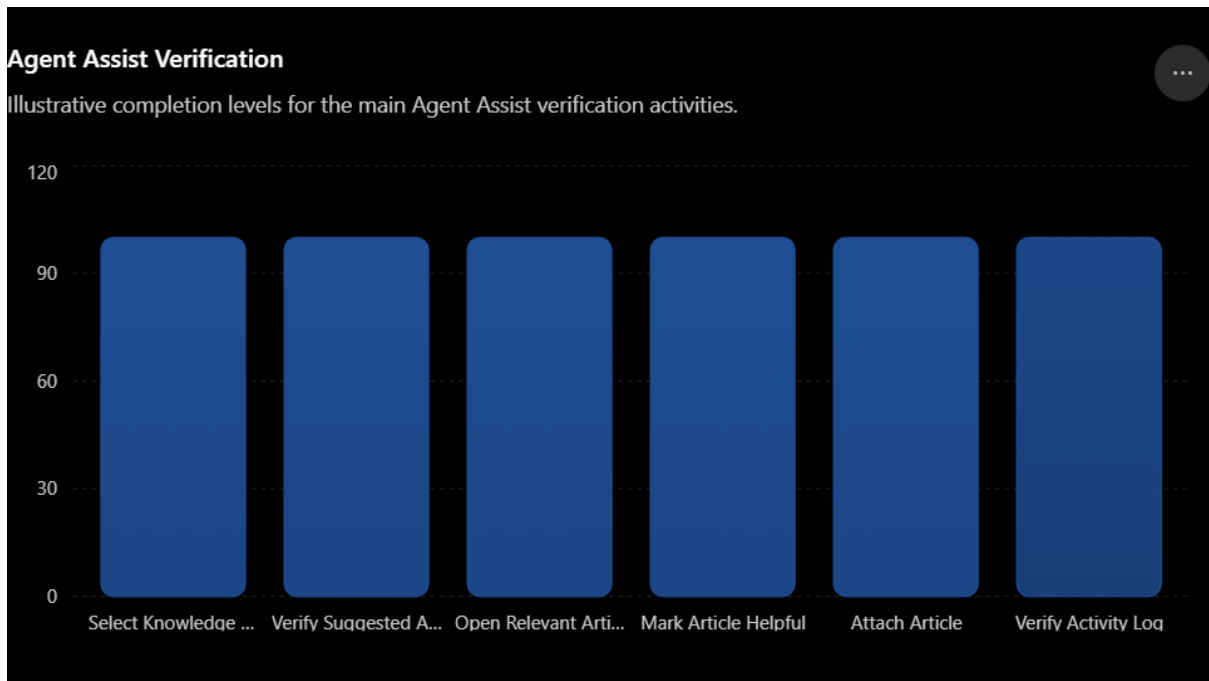
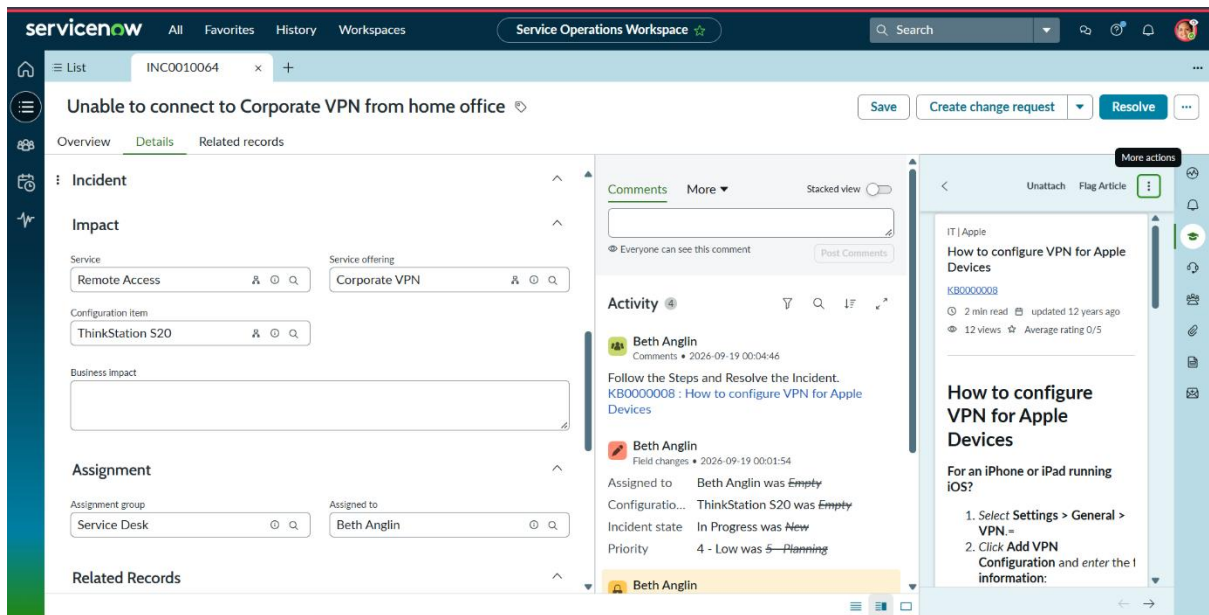
When an agent finds a relevant article through Agent Assist, they can mark the article as Helpful. This provides feedback about the usefulness of the Knowledge Article.

Return to the Knowledge Article or Agent Assist panel and verify that the article shows the **Helpful** indicator.

This confirms that the article was successfully marked as helpful.

Expected Result

Agent Assist successfully identifies relevant Knowledge Articles, the selected article is marked as **Helpful**, attached to the incident, and the related activity is recorded in the incident history.



Phase 6: Reassignment & Escalation

6(A).Watch List Update:

Objective

The objective is to make sure the right people can follow the incident and receive relevant updates while the incident is being investigated and resolved.

The **Watch List** allows additional users to monitor an incident and receive updates about its progress. In this step, the required user is added to the Watch List so they can follow the incident without being assigned as the primary owner.

In your project:

- Samantha Bordwell → Watch list
- Beth Anglin → Work notes list

These lists provide different types of visibility into the incident.

Step-by-Step Process

Step 1: Stay in the Same Incident

Continue working on the same VPN incident that you created earlier.

Do not create a new incident.

The incident should be:

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Step 2: Open the Details Tab

On the incident form, click the:

Details tab

Locate the fields related to:

- Watch list
- Work notes list

These fields allow you to add users who need to monitor the incident.

Step 3: Add Samantha Bordwell to Watch List

Find the Watch list field.

Add:

Samantha Bordwell

If you need to search for the user:

1. Click the Watch list field.
2. Search for Samantha Bordwell.
3. Select her from the available users.
4. Make sure her name appears in the Watch list.

Step 4: Add Beth Anglin to Work Notes List

Find the Work notes list field.

Add:

Beth Anglin

Steps:

1. Click the Work notes list field.

2. Search for Beth Anglin.
3. Select the user.
4. Verify that Beth Anglin appears in the Work notes list.

Step 5: Verify Both Users

Before saving, check:

Field	User
Watch list	Samantha Bordwell

Work notes list Beth Anglin

If your instance doesn't contain either user, follow the project instruction and select another available member.

Step 6: Save the Incident

After adding both users, click:

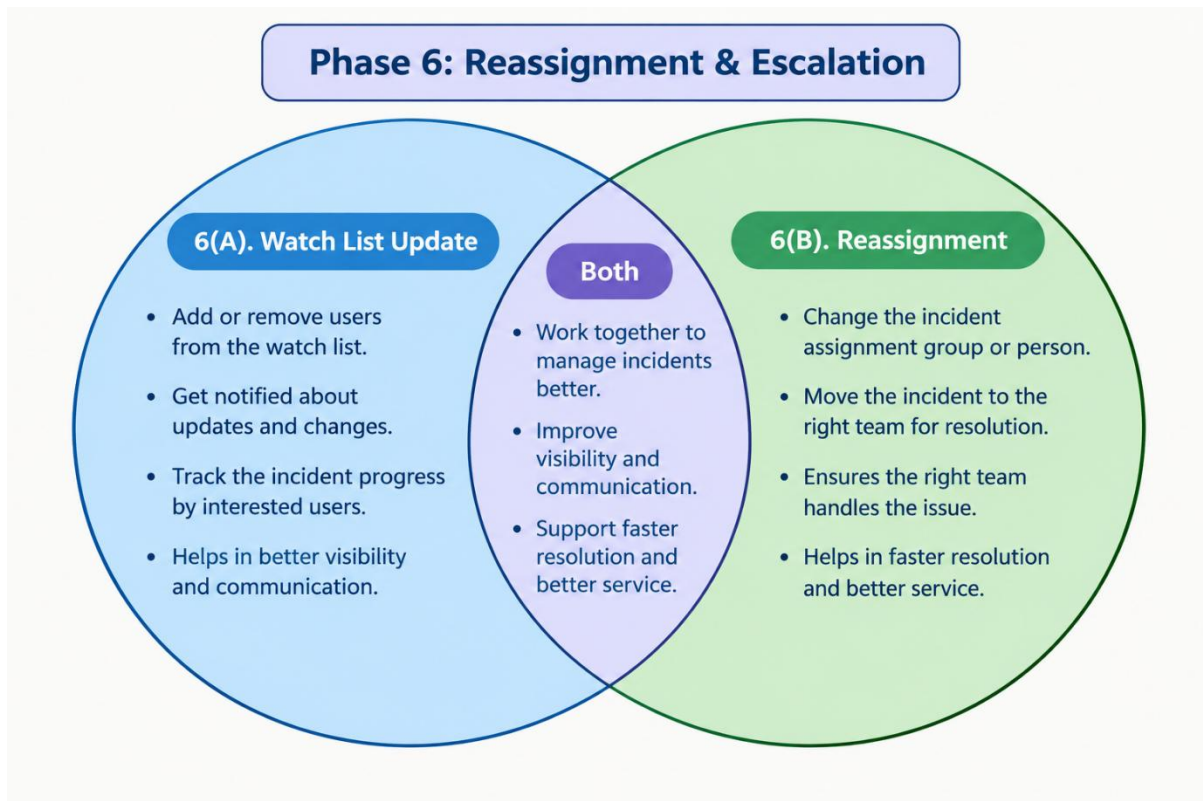
Save

The incident is now updated with the required monitoring participants.

Expected Result

Samantha Bordwell is successfully added to the **Watch List**. She can now monitor the incident and receive relevant updates while the assigned support team continues working on the issue.

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow incident management interface. The incident title is "Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office". The incident details include Location (SHS quadra 5, Bloco E., Brasilia), Urgency (2 - Medium), Priority (4 - Low), Category (Network), Subcategory (VPN), and Opened date (2026-09-18 23:32:13). The Watch list includes Samantha Bordwell and Beth Anglin. The Work notes list includes Beth Anglin. The Activity section shows a comment by Beth Anglin: "Follow the Steps and Resolve the Incident. KB0000008 : How to configure VPN for Apple Devices". The right sidebar shows a knowledge article titled "How to configure VPN for Apple Devices".



6(B).Reassignment:

Objective

The purpose of this step is to assign the VPN incident to the appropriate Network support team.

Since the incident is related to a Corporate VPN / Network issue, the Network team is the appropriate team to investigate and resolve it.

Reassignment is the process of transferring an incident to the appropriate support team when the current team cannot resolve the issue or when specialized technical support is required. In this project, the VPN incident is reassigned to the **Network** support team.

Step-by-Step Process

Step 1: Stay in the Same Incident

Continue working on the same incident created earlier.

The incident should have:

Short Description: Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Do not create a new incident.

Step 2: Open the Details Tab

Open the Details tab of the incident.

Find the:

Assignment group
field.

Step 3: Update Assignment Group

In the Assignment group field, select:Network

This means that the incident is now assigned to the Network Support Team.

The Network team will be responsible for investigating and resolving the VPN-related issue.

Update the **Assignment Group** field to route the incident to the appropriate support team for further investigation and resolution.

- Locate the **Assignment Group** field in the Incident record.
- Select **Network** as the Assignment Group.
- Verify that the **Network** team is correctly selected.
- If required, check the **Assigned to** field and select an appropriate team member.
- Add a work note to document the reassignment.
- Click **Save** to apply the changes.

Step 4: Verify Assigned To Field

After selecting Network, check the Assigned to field.

According to your project requirement, the Assigned to field should automatically clear.

After selecting the **Assignment Group**, verify the **Assigned to** field to ensure the incident is assigned to the appropriate support team member.

- Check the **Assigned to** field after selecting the **Network** assignment group.
- If the field is cleared automatically, select an appropriate member from the **Network** team.
- Confirm that the selected user belongs to the correct assignment group.
- Ensure the assigned user is responsible for investigating and resolving the VPN-related incident.

Step 5: Verify the Assignment

After reassigning the incident, verify that the incident has been assigned to the correct support team.

- Check the Assignment Group field.
- Verify that the Assignment Group is set to Network.
- Check the Assigned to field and confirm that the appropriate support member is selected.
- Ensure the incident is routed to the team responsible for resolving the VPN-related issue.
- Review the Activity section to confirm that the reassignment has been recorded.

Before saving, check:

Field	Expected Value
Assignment Group	Network
Assigned To	Empty / Cleared

If the Assigned To field does not clear automatically in your instance, this can depend on your ServiceNow configuration and business rules. Follow the behavior specified by your project environment.

Step 6: Click Save

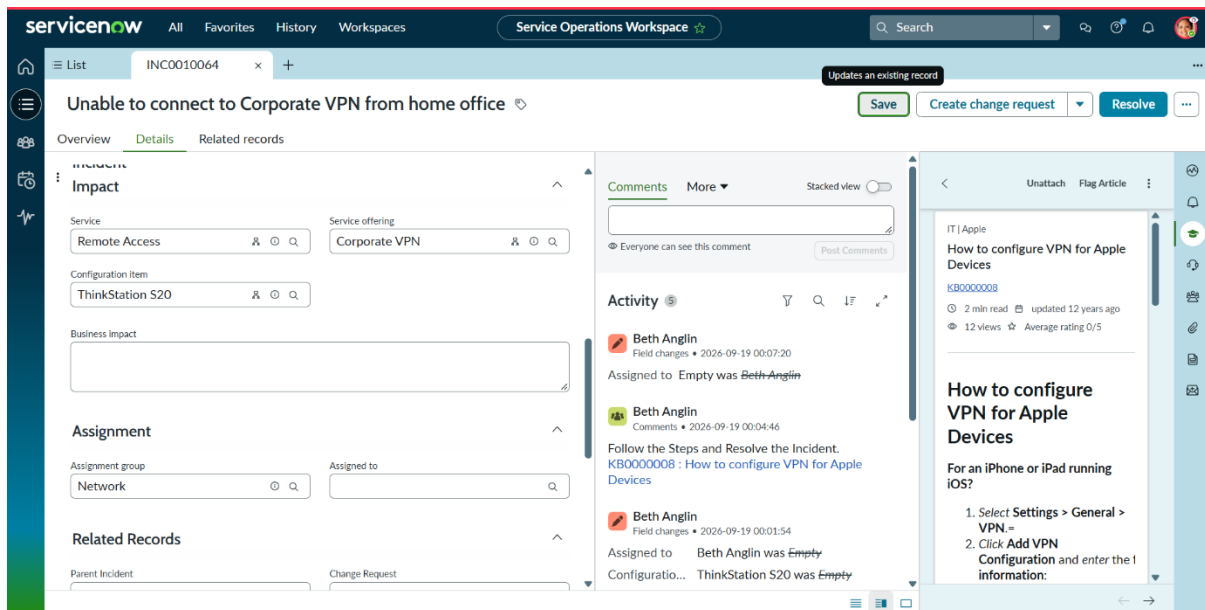
After verifying the fields, click:

Save

The incident is now assigned to the Network support group.

Expected Result

The incident is successfully reassigned to the **Network** support team. The reassignment is recorded in the incident activity, allowing the appropriate technical team to continue investigation and resolution.



Phase 7: Incident Tracking by Level 2

7(A).Investigation by Network Team:

Objective

The Investigation by Network Team step is performed when the incident is reassigned to the Level 2 Network Support Team. The team reviews the incident details, investigates the reported VPN issue, checks the related configuration item, and determines the appropriate resolution.

The purpose of this step is to verify that:

- David Loo can access the incident.
- The VPN incident contains the correct description.
- The Knowledge Article is still linked.
- SLA information is available.
- The incident can be assigned to the current support user.

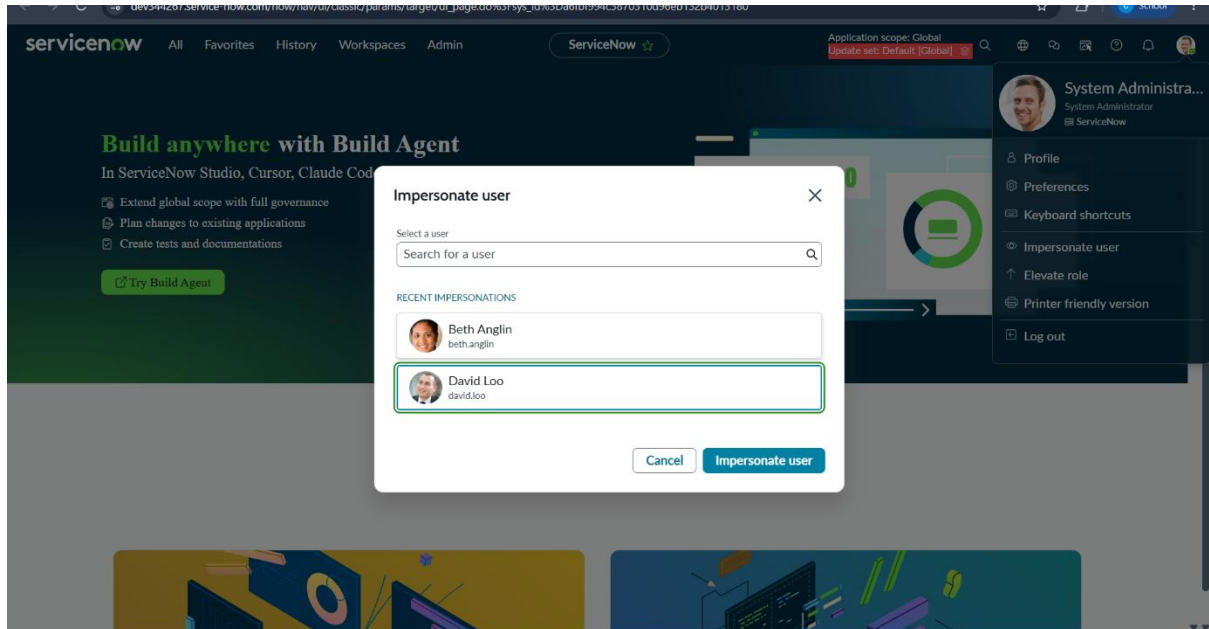
This confirms that important information is preserved throughout the Incident Management lifecycle.

Step 1: Impersonate David Loo

First, impersonate **David Loo**.

- 1.Open the ServiceNow user/profile menu.
- 2.Select **Impersonate User**.

3. Search for **David Loo**.
4. Select **David Loo**.
5. Confirm the impersonation.



Step 2: Open the Banner Menu

After impersonating David Loo, look at the top **Banner** of the ServiceNow interface.

Click the:

Three dots (⋮)

This opens additional navigation options.

Step 3: Select Workspaces

From the three-dot menu:

1. Select **Workspaces**.
2. Navigate to: **Service Operations Workspace**

Open the workspace.

Step 4: Open Incidents

Navigate to Service Operations **Workspace** → **Incidents** → **Open** and locate the previously created Corporate VPN incident.

Inside **Service Operations Workspace**:

1. Go to **Incidents**.
2. Select **Open**.

This displays the list of open incidents.

Step 5: Open the VPN Incident

Find the incident created earlier:

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Click the incident to open it.

Make sure you are opening the **same incident**, not creating a new one.

Step 6: Click "Assign to Me"

Inside the incident, click:

Assign to me

This assigns the incident to **David Loo**, the current user.

The **Assigned to** field should now reflect David Loo, depending on your ServiceNow configuration.

Step 7: Verify the Description

Check the incident's **Description** field.

It should contain:

Michael advised he was able to connect yesterday evening, but this morning received an authentication error. The Internet works fine.

Step 8: Verify Knowledge Articles

Check the **Agent Assist / Knowledge** area.

Verify that the Knowledge Article attached during the previous step is still visible or associated with the incident.

The article should provide troubleshooting information related to the VPN issue.

Review the **Knowledge Articles** available in the Agent Assist section to find relevant troubleshooting information for the VPN incident.

- Open the **Knowledge Articles** section in the incident.
- Check the articles suggested for the **Corporate VPN authentication issue**.
- Open the relevant article and review the troubleshooting steps.
- Confirm that the article provides useful information for investigating or resolving the incident.

- Verify that the required article is attached to the incident if applicable.

Step 9: Verify SLA in Related Records

Open the Related Records section of the incident and verify the Task SLAs associated with the incident.

- Open the Related Records tab.
- Locate the Task SLAs section.
- Verify that the SLA record is displayed for the incident.
- Check the SLA details such as SLA Name, Stage, Start Time, and Due Time.
- Confirm that the SLA is actively tracking the incident within the expected time.
- Ensure there are no missing or incorrect SLA records.

Go to the incident's:

Related Records

section.

Look for:

Task SLAs

Open or expand the Task SLAs section.

Expected Result:

The **Level 2 Network Team** successfully reviews and investigates the VPN incident.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for an incident record. The incident title is "Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office" with ID INC0010064. The status is "In Progress" and the priority is "Low". The summary section contains a description of the issue and a table of details:

Field	Value
Number	INC0010064
Priority	4 - Low
Opened	2026-09-18 23:32:13
State	3 - Low
Urgency	2 - Medium

The "Impact" section shows a "Low" impact level. The "Activity" section shows a list of actions, including "Field changes" and "Assigned to". The "Record Information" section shows the "SLAs and timings" for the incident, with a "Response SLA" of 24 hours and a "Resolution SLA" of 1 week. The "Caller" information is also displayed, showing the name "Michael Hoefer" and contact details.

Phase 8: Emergency Change Request Creation

8(A).Create Change:

Objective

The purpose of adding Work Notes is to record the internal actions performed by the Service Desk agent before the incident is reassigned or escalated to another support team.

Work Notes provide a clear history of the incident and help the next support team understand what has already been done.

The objective of this step is to update the Configuration Item (CI) associated with the incident and place the incident in the On Hold state while waiting for a required change.

If resolving the incident requires a system or configuration change, an **Emergency Change Request** can be created to address the issue quickly while maintaining proper change tracking and approval.

Step-by-Step Process

Step 1: Open the Incident

1. Stay on the same VPN incident record.
2. If you are not on the incident, open Service Operations Workspace.
3. Navigate to Incidents → Open.
4. Search for and open the VPN incident.

Screenshot:

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow 'Service Operations Workspace' interface. The incident title is 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office' with ID INCO010064. The incident is currently in the 'On Hold' state with a reason of 'Awaiting Change'. The caller is Michael Hoefer. The location is SHS quadra 5, Bloco E., Brasilia. The channel is Phone. The category is Network. The priority is 4 - Low. The impact is 3 - Low. The urgency is 2 - Medium. The description states: 'Michael advised he was able to connect yesterday evening, but this morning received an authentication error. The Internet works fine.' The activity log shows three entries by David Loo: 'Field changes' at 2026-09-19 00:10:46, 'Relationship change' at 2026-09-19 00:10:02, and 'Field changes' at 2026-09-19 00:10:01. The configuration item is 'PowerEdge T110 II was ThinkStation 520'. The record information shows the incident was last updated by David Loo on 2026-09-19 00:10:46. The SLAs and timings section shows the response SLA as 'Completed' and the resolution SLA as '1 wk 2d'. The caller's contact information is listed as Michael Hoefer, Development, Brasilia - 00:10:47, America/Los_Angeles. The incident is assigned to David Loo.

Step 2: Update the Configuration Item

The purpose of updating the Configuration Item (CI) is to make sure that the emergency change request is associated with the correct IT component affected by the incident.

In this project, the Configuration Item is updated to PowerEdge, which is the component related to the VPN service issue.

1. Go to the Details section/tab of the incident.
2. Find the Configuration Item field.
3. The current Configuration Item is ThickStation.
4. Click the Configuration Item field.
5. Search for PowerEdge.
6. Select PowerEdge from the available results.

The field should now show:

Configuration Item: PowerEdge

7. Click Save

Step 3: Return to the Incident

After creating the Emergency Change Request, return to the original Corporate VPN incident to continue the incident resolution process.

1. After saving the Configuration Item, return to the same incident record.
2. Open the incident details again.
3. Locate the State field.

Step 4: Change the Incident State

Update the Incident State to reflect the current progress of the incident and indicate that the issue is waiting for the emergency change to be completed.

1. Find the State field.
2. Change the State from its current value to: On Hold

Step 5: Select On Hold Reason

When the incident requires a change or additional action before it can be resolved, place the incident in the On Hold state.

After selecting On Hold, an On Hold Reason field will appear.

1. Click the On Hold Reason field.
2. Select: Awaiting Change

The fields should now show:

- State: On Hold
- On Hold Reason: Awaiting Change

Step 6: Save the Incident

After entering and verifying all the required incident information, save the incident record to ensure the changes are stored in ServiceNow.

1. Verify the values carefully.
2. Click Save.
3. Wait for the incident to refresh.
4. Verify that the incident remains in On Hold state.

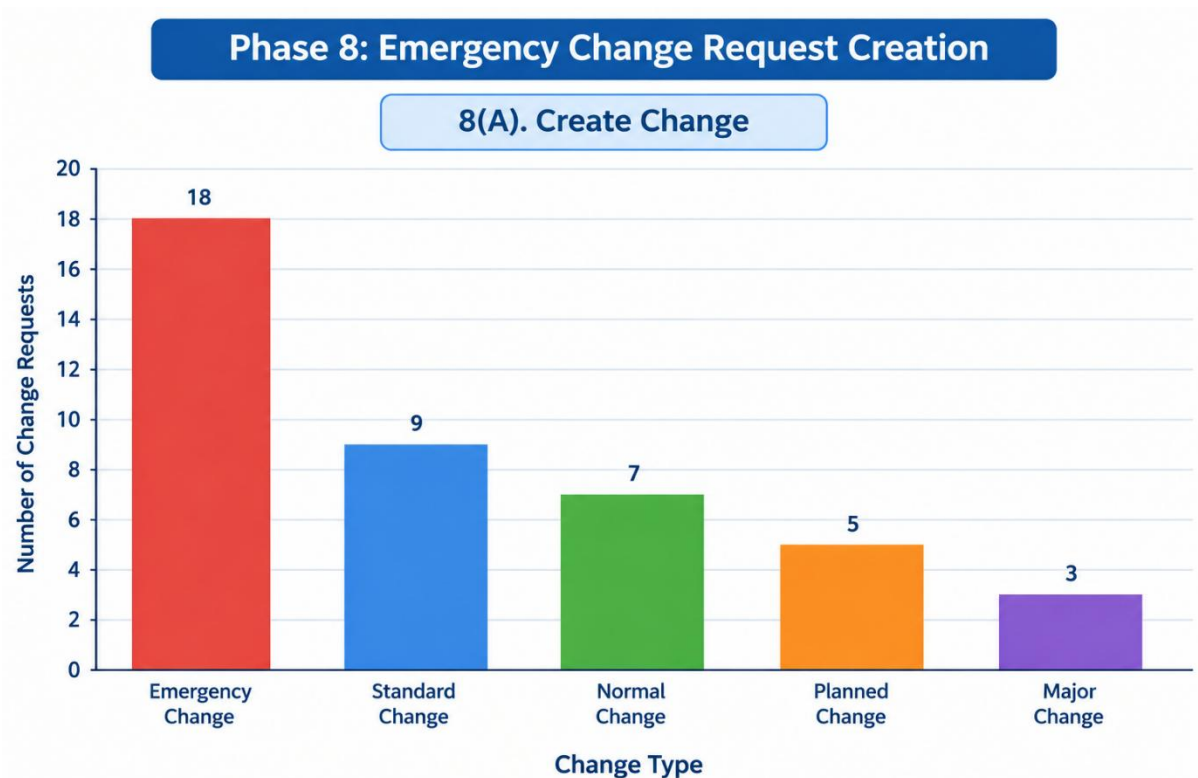
Expected Result:

An **Emergency Change Request** is successfully created and associated with the VPN incident. The change can then be tracked separately while supporting the incident resolution process.

Screenshot:

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow interface for an incident titled "Unable to connect to Corporate VPN". The incident number is INC0010067. The state is "On Hold" with an "Awaiting Change" reason. The caller is Aileen Mottern. The location is Via Nomentana 56, Rome. The impact is "3 - Low", urgency is "3 - Low", and priority is "5 - Planning". The category is "Inquiry / Help". The incident was opened by David Loo on 2026-09-19 00:12:11. The activity log shows a field change by David Loo at the same time. The right sidebar shows the caller's information and that the incident has not been assigned yet.

Field	Value
Number	INC0010067
State	On Hold
On hold reason	Awaiting Change
Caller	Aileen Mottern
Location	Via Nomentana 56, Rome
Impact	3 - Low
Urgency	3 - Low
Priority	5 - Planning
Category	Inquiry / Help
Opened by	David Loo
Opened on	2026-09-19 00:12:11



Phase 9: Child Incident Creation

9(A).Create Child Incident:

Objective

The objective of this step is to create a **Child Incident** from the existing parent incident.

A child incident is used when a specific issue needs to be tracked separately while still maintaining a relationship with the main/parent incident.

In this project, the parent incident is related to a **Corporate VPN authentication problem**. A child incident is created to track the individual VPN connection issue.

Step-by-Step Process

Step 1: Open the Parent Incident

1. Open the existing **VPN parent incident**.
2. Make sure you are on the correct incident record.
3. Scroll down to the **Related Records** section/tab.

Screenshot:

The screenshot shows the 'Create New Incident' form in ServiceNow. The form is titled 'Create New Incident' and has tabs for 'Details' and 'Create New Inci...'. The 'Details' tab is active. The form includes fields for 'Short description *', 'Description', 'Number' (INC0010067), 'State' (New), 'Caller *', 'Impact' (3 - Low), 'Location', 'Urgency' (3 - Low), 'Channel' (None), and 'Priority' (5 - Planning). There are 'Save' and 'Assign to me' buttons at the top right. A 'Loading' spinner is visible on the right side of the form.

Step 2: Open Child Incidents

1. In **Related Records**, locate **Child Incidents**.
2. Click **New**.

This opens a new incident form for creating the child incident.

Screenshot:

The screenshot shows the 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN' incident form in ServiceNow. The form is titled 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN' and has tabs for 'Overview', 'Details', and 'Related records'. The 'Overview' tab is active. The form includes a 'Summary' section with 'Short description' (Unable to connect to Corporate VPN), 'Description' (User receiving VPN authentication failure error.), 'Number' (INC0010067), 'Priority' (5 - Planning), 'Opened' (2026-09-19 00:11:26), 'State' (On Hold), 'Impact' (3 - Low), and 'Urgency' (3 - Low). There is an 'Impact' section with 'Impact Summary'. The 'Compose' section shows 'Work notes' and 'Activity' (David Loo, Field changes • 2026-09-19 00:12:11). The 'Record Information' section shows 'Caller' (Aileen Mottern, Customer Support, Rome - 001214, America/Los Angeles) and 'Assigned to' (This Incident has not been assigned yet). There are 'Save', 'Create change request', 'Assign to me', and 'Resolve' buttons at the top right.

Step 3: Enter Short Description

In the **Short Description** field, enter:

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN

This gives a clear summary of the problem.

Step 4: Select Caller

1. Find the **Caller** field.
2. Select **any available user** from the list.
3. For example, you can select an existing user available in your ServiceNow instance.

Step 5: Enter Description

In the **Description** field, enter:

User receiving VPN authentication failure error.

This provides additional information about the problem.

The child incident should now contain:

Field	Value
Short Description	Unable to connect to Corporate VPN
Caller	Any available user
Description	User receiving VPN authentication failure error.

Step 6: Save the Child Incident

1. Review the entered information.
2. Click **Save**.
3. ServiceNow will create the child incident.
4. ServiceNow will generate a unique **Incident Number**, such as INC0012345.

Step 7: Return to the Parent Incident

1. Return to the original **parent incident**.
2. Open the **Related Records** section/tab again.
3. Locate **Child Incidents**.

Step 8: Verify the Child Incident

Under **Child Incidents**, verify that the newly created incident is listed.

Check that:

- The child incident appears under the parent incident.

- The Short Description is **Unable to connect to Corporate VPN**.
- The generated Incident Number is displayed.
- The child incident is linked to the parent incident.

ServiceNow | All | Favorites | History | Workspaces | Service Operations Workspace | Application scope: Global | Update set: Default (cable)

INC0010064 | INC0010067

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN | Save | Create change request | Assign to me | Resolve

Overview | **Details** | Related records

Incident

User receiving VPN authentication failure error.

Number: INC0010067 | State: On Hold

Caller: Aileen Mottern | On hold reason: Awaiting Change

Location: Via Nomentana 56, Rome | Impact: 3 - Low

Channel: -- None -- | Urgency: 3 - Low

Category: Inquiry / Help | Priority: 5 - Planning

Subcategory: -- None -- | Watch list:

Comments | More | Stacked view

Everyone can see this comment | Post Comments

Activity

David Loo | Field changes • 2026-09-19 00:12:11

Impact: 3 - Low | Incident state: On Hold | Opened by: David Loo | Priority: 5 - Planning

Record Information

Last updated by David Loo | 2026-09-19 00:12:11

Caller

Aileen Mottern | Customer Support | Rome - 00:12:14 | America/Los Angeles

Contact

Recent incidents > | Recent interactions > | Assigned assets >

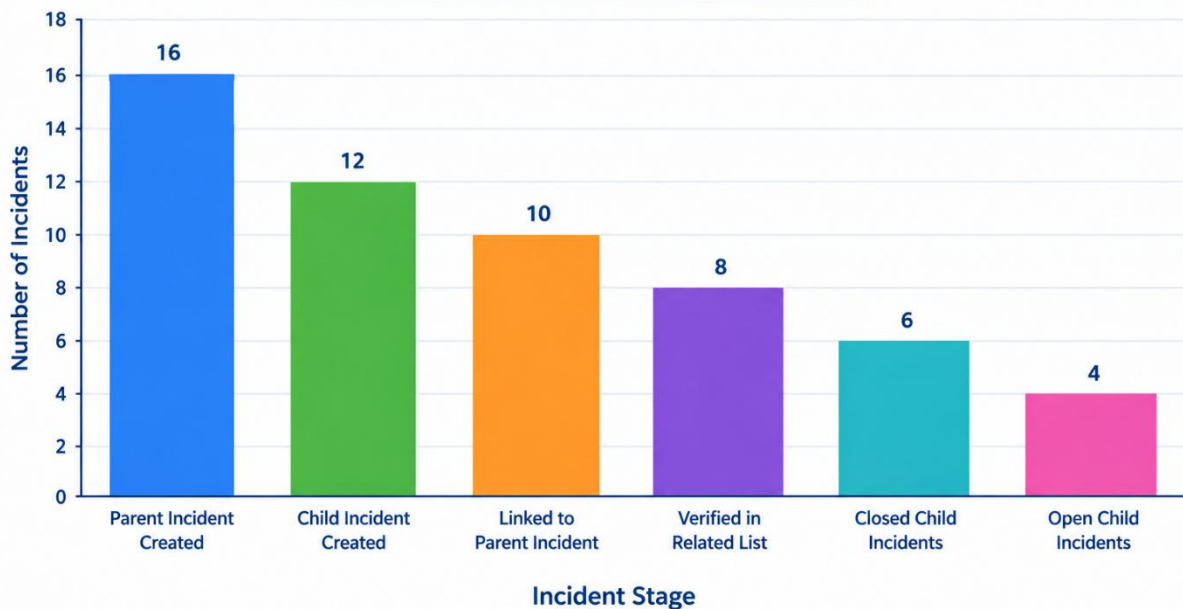
Assigned to

This Incident has not been assigned yet

Assign to me

Phase 9: Child Incident Creation

9(A). Create Child Incident



Phase 10: Incident Resolution

10(A).Add Cause:

Objective

The objective of this step is to identify and record the probable cause of the incident.

In this project, the VPN issue occurred because the PowerEdge service was suspended and needed to be restarted.

Recording the probable cause helps the support team understand the reason for the incident and provides useful information for future troubleshooting.

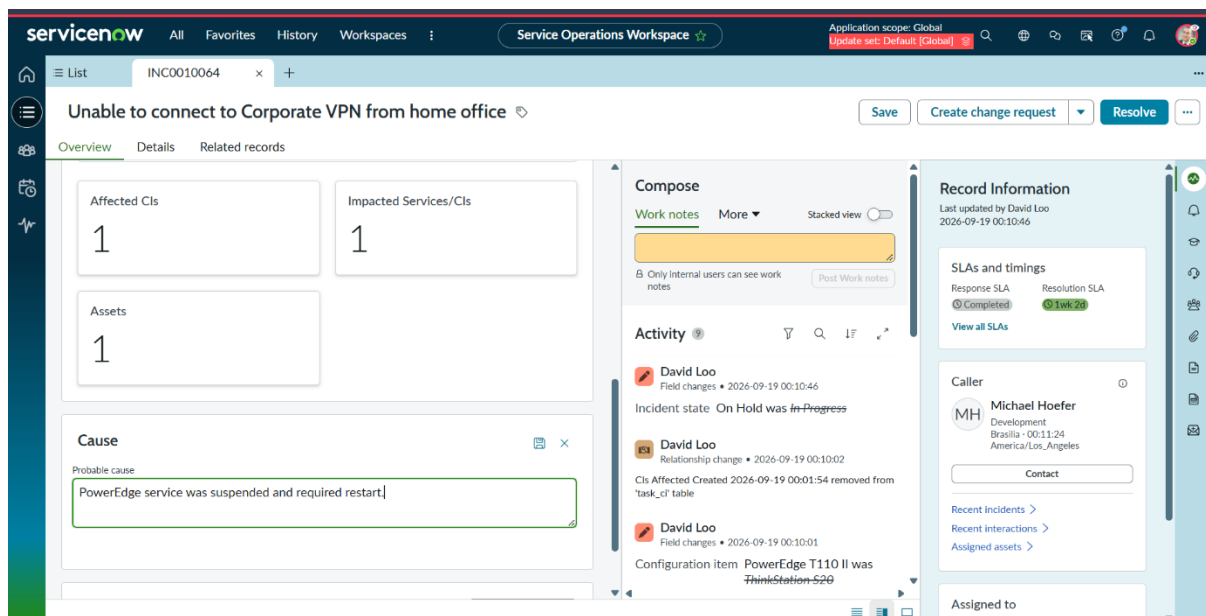
The **Add Cause** step is used to document the identified or probable reason for the incident. Recording the cause helps the support team understand why the issue occurred and provides useful information for future troubleshooting.

Step-by-Step Process

Step 1: Open the Incident

1. Open the existing parent VPN incident.
2. Make sure you are working on the correct incident record.
3. Open the Overview tab.

Screenshot:

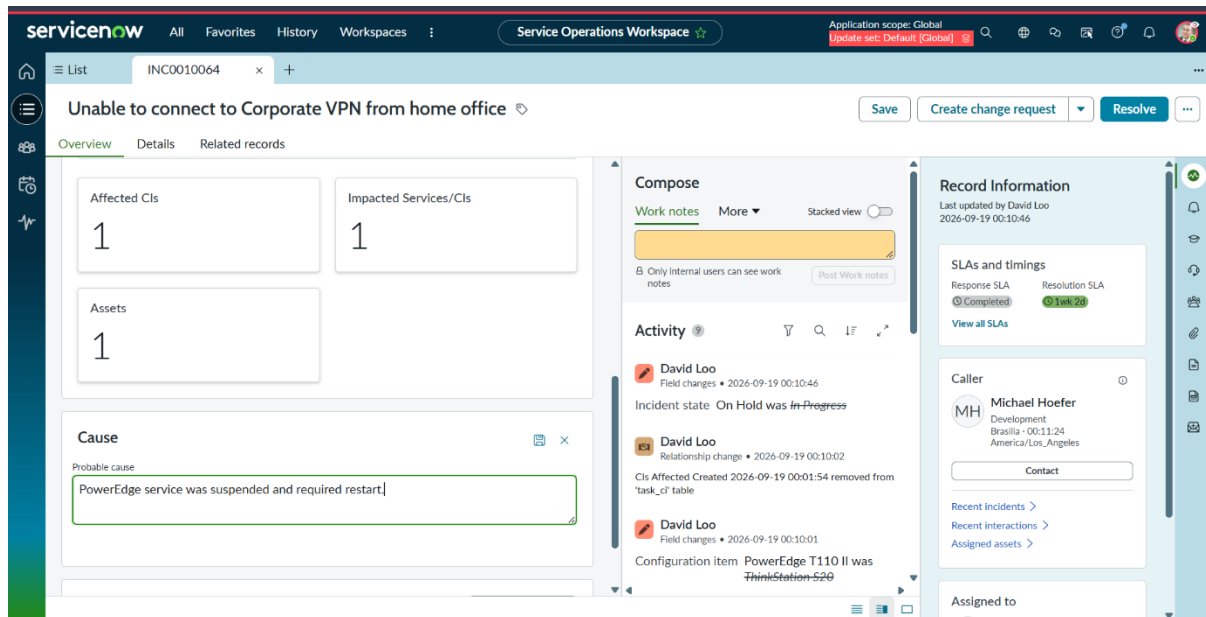


Step 2: Click Add Cause

1. In the Overview tab, locate the Cause section.
2. Click Add Cause.

3. A field or dialog box will appear where you can enter the probable cause.

Screenshot:



Step 3: Enter Probable Cause

In the **Probable Cause** field, enter the identified reason for the incident based on the investigation findings.

Probable Cause:

PowerEdge service was suspended and required restart.

This information explains the likely cause of the **Corporate VPN authentication issue** and helps maintain a clear record for future troubleshooting and reference.

Step 4: Save the Cause

After entering the probable cause, verify the information and save the incident record.

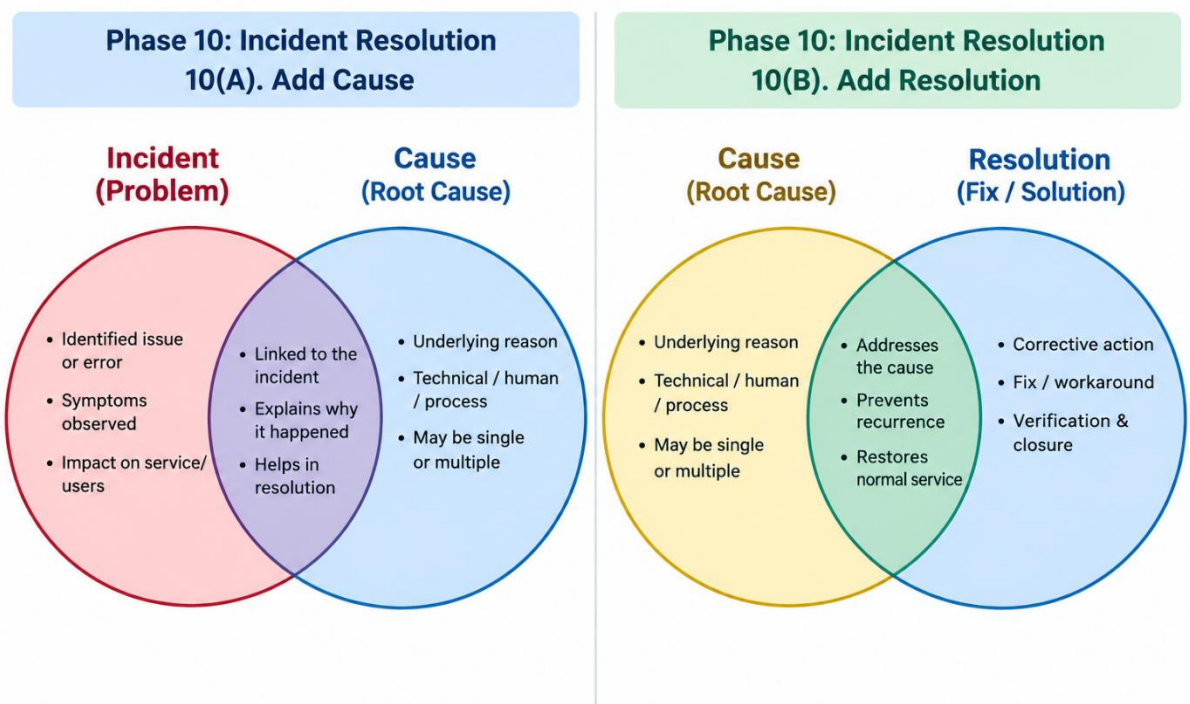
1. Review the entered information.
2. Click Save.
3. Verify that the probable cause is displayed in the incident.

Expected Result:

The **Probable Cause** is successfully added to the incident, providing a clear record of why the VPN connectivity issue occurred.

Screenshot:

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow incident management interface. The incident title is "Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office". The Overview tab is active, showing 1 Affected CI, 1 Impacted Service/CI, and 1 Asset. The Cause section indicates a probable cause: "PowerEdge service was suspended and required restart". The Activity section shows a log of actions by David Loo, including field changes and a relationship change. The Record Information section shows SLAs and timings, with a response SLA of 1hr:20 and a resolution SLA of 1hr:20. The Caller is Michael Hoefer.



10(B).Add Resolution:

Objective

The objective of this step is to document the action taken to resolve the VPN incident and then officially mark the incident as **Resolved**.

In this project, the VPN issue was handled by restarting the required service according to an **emergency change request**.

The **Add Resolution** step is used to record how the incident was resolved. It captures the **probable cause, resolution method, and resolution notes** so that the support team has a complete record of the solution.

Step 1: Open the Parent Incident

1. Open the same **parent VPN incident**.
2. Verify that you are working on the correct incident.
3. Make sure the incident contains the previously entered **Probable Cause**.

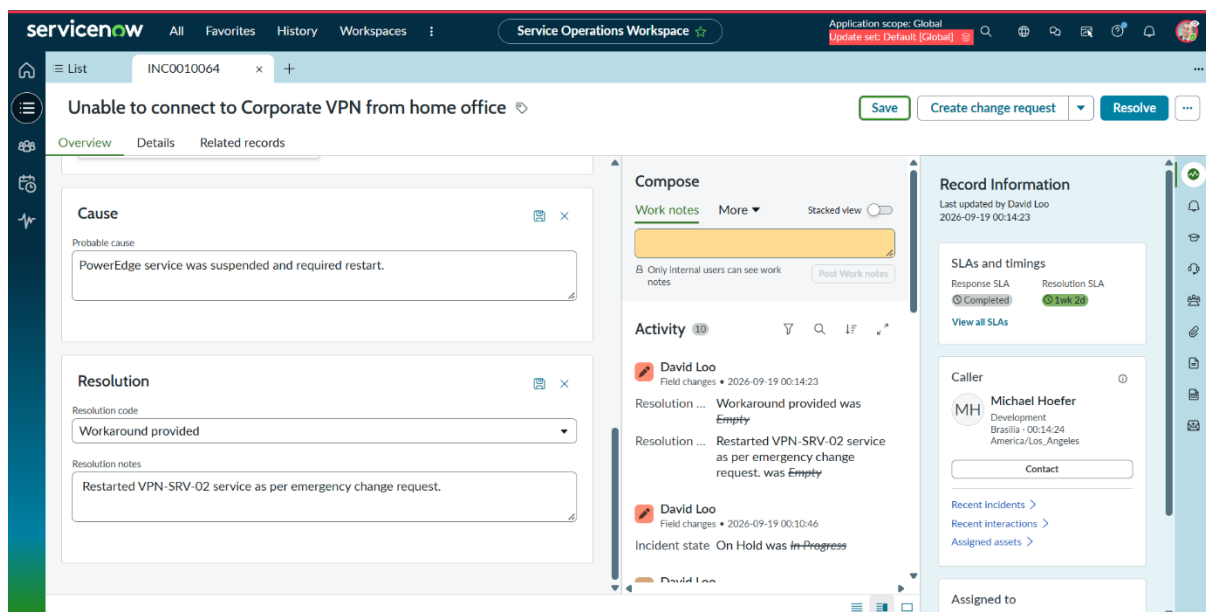
The previously recorded probable cause was:

PowerEdge service was suspended and required restart.

Step 2: Add Resolution

1. Locate the **Resolution** section.
2. Click **Add Resolution**.
3. The resolution fields will be displayed.

Screenshot:



Step 3: Select Resolution Code

In the Resolution Code field, select the appropriate option that describes how the incident was resolved.

For this project:

- Select Workaround provided.

- Verify that the selected resolution code matches the action taken to resolve the VPN issue.
- Ensure the resolution code is selected before entering the final resolution notes.
- Review the selected value and save the incident.

Step 4: Enter Resolution Notes

In the **Resolution Notes** field, enter:

Restarted VPN-SRV-02 service as per emergency change request.

Step 5: Save the Resolution

1. Verify the Resolution Code.
2. Verify the Resolution Notes.
3. Click **Save resolution**.
4. Confirm that the resolution information has been recorded.

The expected values are:

Field	Value
Resolution Code	Workaround provided

Resolution Notes Restarted VPN-SRV-02 service as per emergency change request.

Screenshot:

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow incident management interface. The incident title is "Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office". The "Cause" field is populated with "PowerEdge service was suspended and required restart." The "Resolution" field shows a dropdown menu with "Workaround provided" selected, and the "Resolution notes" field contains "Restarted VPN-SRV-02 service as per emergency change request." The "Activity" panel on the right shows a timeline of actions: David Loo updated the field changes on 2026-09-19 00:14:41, and later updated the resolution notes on 2026-09-19 00:14:23. The "Record Information" panel shows the incident is resolved, with SLAs marked as "Completed" and "Paused". The caller is identified as Michael Hoefer from the Development team in Brasilia.

Step 6: Click Resolve

After saving the resolution:

1. Locate the **Resolve** button.
2. Click **Resolve**.
3. A confirmation popup will appear.

The popup asks you to confirm that you want to resolve the incident.

Step 7: Confirm the Resolution

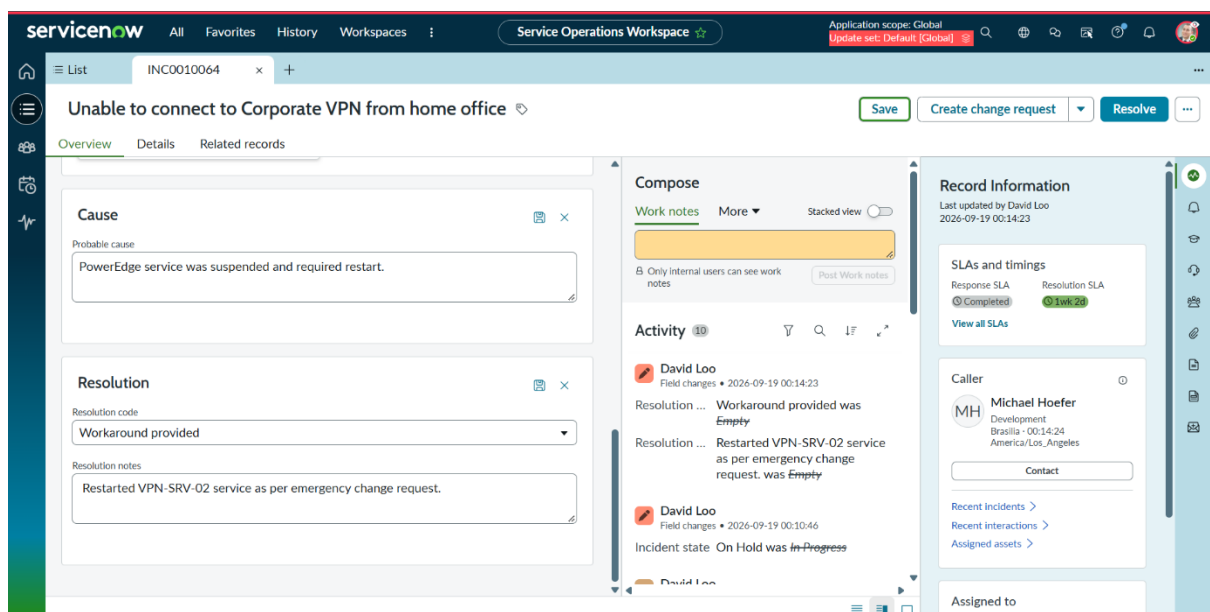
Before resolving the incident, verify that the issue has been properly investigated and the required resolution details have been entered.

- Verify the **Probable Cause** is correct.
- Confirm the **Resolution Code** is selected as **Workaround provided**.
- Verify the **Resolution Notes** accurately describe the action taken.
- Confirm that the related **Emergency Change Request** has been completed or properly linked.
- Check that the VPN issue has been resolved and the service is working as expected.
- Review the incident **Activity Log** to ensure all important actions are recorded.
- After confirming the resolution, update the incident to **Resolved**.

The incident State should now change to:

Resolved

Screenshot:



Step 8: Verify the Incident

After the incident is resolved, verify:

- **State:** Resolved
- **Resolution Code:** Workaround provided
- **Resolution Notes:** Restarted VPN-SRV-02 service as per emergency change request.
- Probable Cause is still available.
- Incident information is saved correctly.

Expected Result:

The incident is successfully updated with the **cause, resolution code, and resolution notes**, and the incident can be moved to the **Resolved** state.

Phase 11: Knowledge Creation

11(A).Create Knowledge Article:

Objective

The objective of this step is to create a **Knowledge Article** using the information from the resolved incident.

The article stores the problem and its solution in the **IT Knowledge Base** so that support agents can search for and use the solution when similar incidents occur.

The **Create Knowledge Article** step is used to convert the solution from a resolved incident into a reusable **Knowledge Article**. This allows support teams to use the documented solution when similar VPN issues occur in the future.

Step 1: Open the Parent Incident

Open the resolved **Corporate VPN** incident in **Service Operations Workspace**.

Screenshot:

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for creating a Knowledge Article. The top navigation bar includes 'All', 'Favorites', 'History', 'Workspaces', and 'Service Operations Workspace'. The main header displays 'KB0010004 v0.01' with buttons for 'Publish', 'Save', and 'View Article'. The left sidebar shows 'Details' and 'Related records'. The main content area is titled 'Knowledge' and contains the following fields:

- Knowledge base ***: A dropdown menu with 'IT' selected.
- Category**: A dropdown menu.
- Short description ***: A text field containing 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office'.
- Article body**: A rich text editor with a toolbar showing 'Verdana', '10pt', 'B', 'I', 'U', 'A', 'List', 'Link', 'Paragraph', 'Q', 'Q', 'Q', and '...'. The body contains two paragraphs:
 - Issue** - Michael advised he was able to connect yesterday evening, but this morning received an authentication error. The Internet works fine.
 - Resolution** - Restarted VPN-SRV-02 service as per emergency change request.

On the right side, there is an 'Agent Assist' panel with a search bar and three suggested articles:

- Article**: 'Unable to connect to Corp...' (updated 12 years ago - 12 views)
- Article**: 'How to configure VPN for Apple ...' (updated 12 years ago - 12 views)
- Article**: 'Automatic Replies (Out Of Office)' (updated 4 years ago - 86 views)
- Article**: 'Excel Functionality' (updated 4 years ago - 86 views)

Step 2: Click Create Knowledge

1. Click **Create Knowledge**.
2. ServiceNow will open the Knowledge Article creation form.

The system may automatically copy relevant information from the incident into the new Knowledge Article.

Screenshot:

This screenshot is identical to the one above, showing the ServiceNow interface for creating a Knowledge Article. It displays the same navigation bar, header, sidebar, and main content area with the 'Knowledge' form fields and the 'Agent Assist' panel.

Step 3: Select Knowledge Base

The purpose of selecting a Knowledge Base is to identify where the new Knowledge Article should be stored.

For this project, the Knowledge Article is related to the Corporate VPN incident, so it should be stored in the IT Knowledge Base.

- Click **Create Knowledge** from the resolved incident.
- In the Knowledge Article form, locate the **Knowledge Base** field.
- Select **IT** as the Knowledge Base.
- Verify that the selected Knowledge Base is correct before continuing.
- Select the appropriate **Template**, such as **Standard**, if required.
- Click **Next** to continue creating the Knowledge Article.

Step 4: Select Article Template

Find the **Article Template** field.

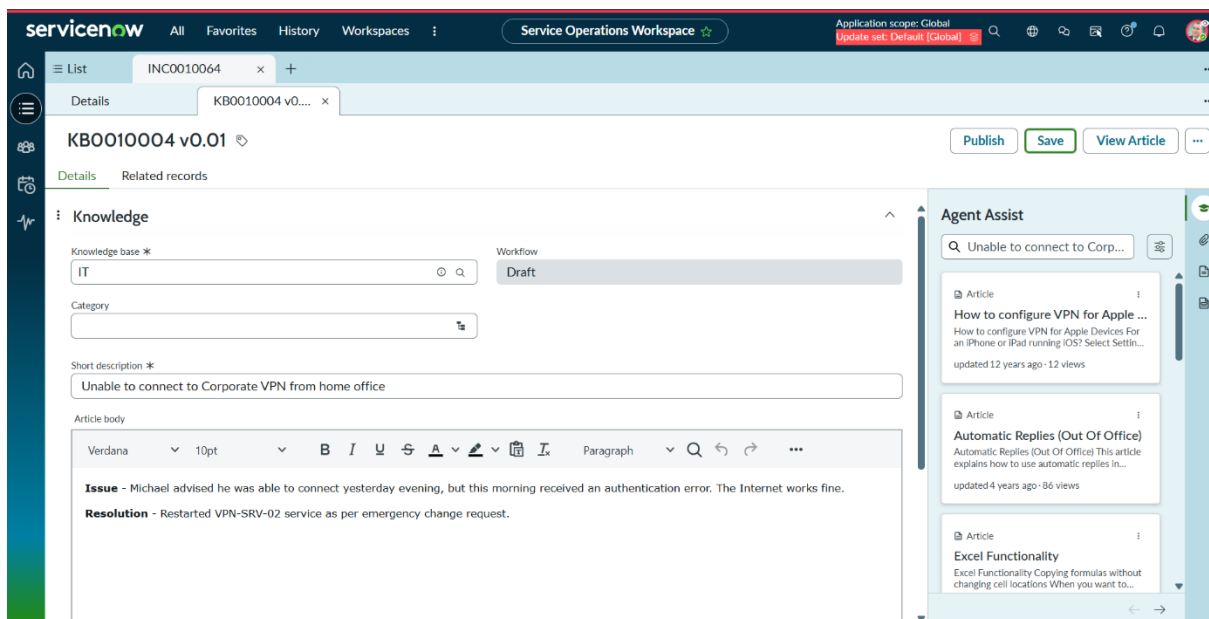
Select:

Standard

Then click:

Next

Screenshot:



Step 5: Verify the Knowledge Article Details

After creating the Knowledge Article from the resolved incident, verify that all the article information is correct and complete before saving it.

- Verify the Knowledge Base is selected as IT.
- Confirm the Article Template is Standard.
- Check that the Article Title clearly describes the VPN issue.
- Verify that the Article Content contains the correct troubleshooting steps and resolution.

- Confirm that the information matches the resolution documented in the incident.
- Check that there are no missing or incorrect details.
- Click Save after verifying all the information.

After selecting **Standard** → **Next**, ServiceNow displays the Knowledge Article details.

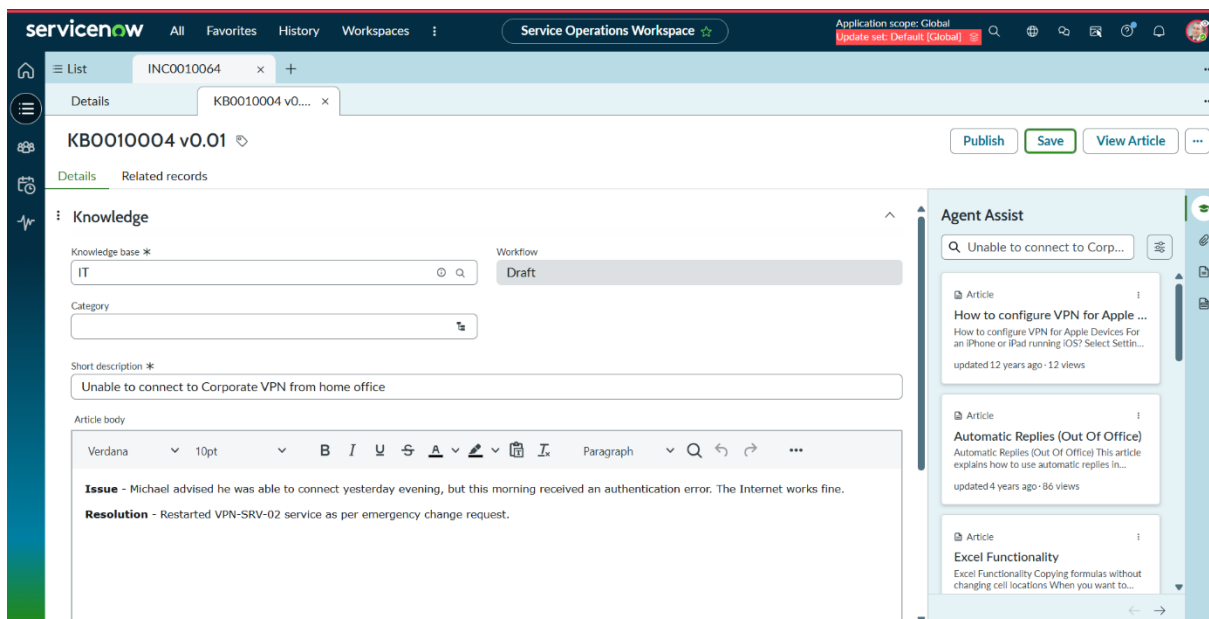
Carefully review the information.

Check that the article contains relevant information from the incident, such as:

- Problem/issue description
- VPN-related information
- Probable Cause
- Resolution information
- Troubleshooting or solution details

For this incident, the important resolution information is:

Screenshot:



Step 6: Save the Knowledge Article

1. Review all the details.
2. Make sure there are no incorrect or missing values.
3. Click **Save**.
4. ServiceNow creates the Knowledge Article.

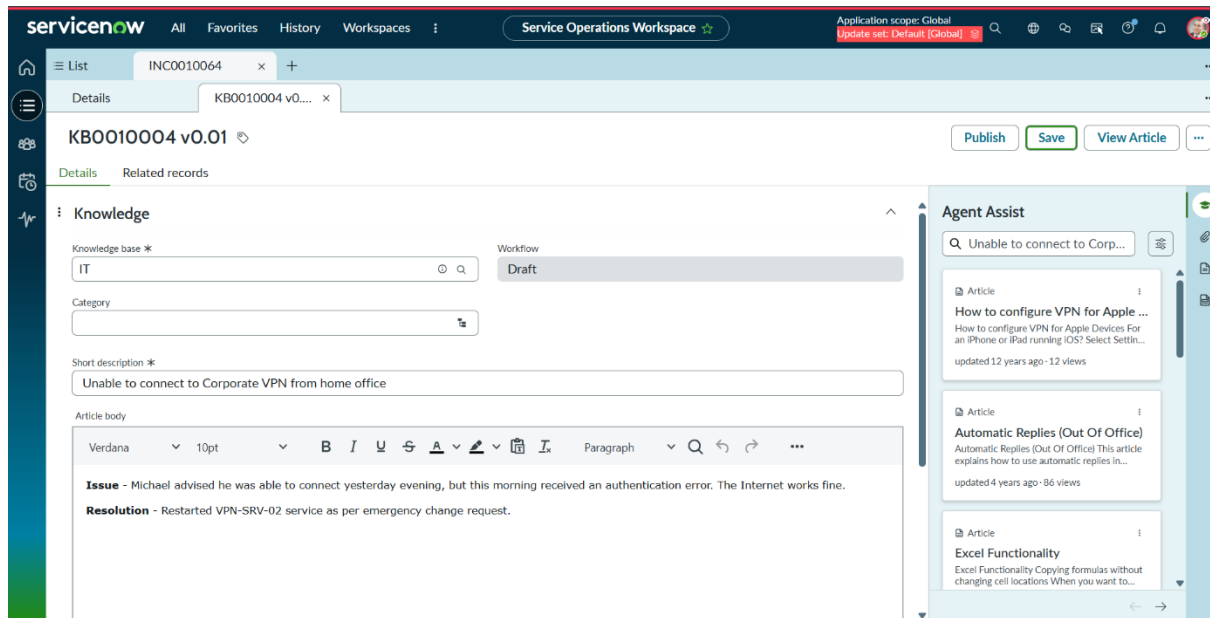
The system may generate a unique Knowledge Article number.

For example:

KB0010004

The actual number will be generated by your ServiceNow instance.

Screenshot:



Step 7: Return to the Parent Incident

After saving the Knowledge Article:

1. Return to the original **Parent Incident**.
2. Open the **Related Records** section/tab.
3. Look for the **Created Knowledge** related list.

Screenshot:

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow 'Service Operations Workspace' for an incident with ID INC0010064. The incident title is 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office'. The incident is in the 'Resolved' state with a priority of '5 - Planning'. The 'Related records' tab is active, showing a list of child incidents. The 'Record Information' panel on the right shows the caller as Michael Hoefer and the incident was last updated by David Loo on 2026-09-19 00:14:40.

Child Incidents (1)	Service	Priority	State	Assignment group	Assigned to	Opened
Attached Knowledge (2)	/ Help	(empty)	5 - Planning	Resolved	(empty)	2026-09-19 00:14:40

Step 8: Verify Created Knowledge

Under:

Related Records → Created Knowledge

verify that the newly created Knowledge Article is listed.

Check:

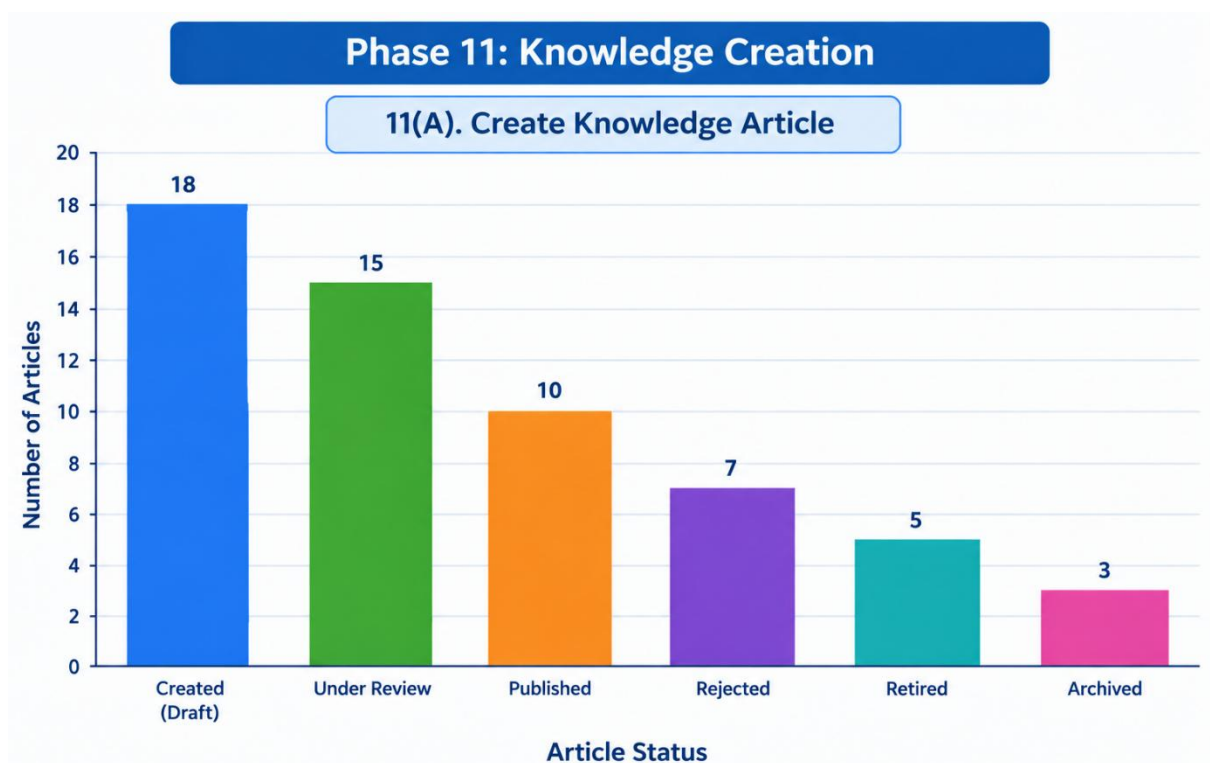
- Knowledge Article is present.
- Knowledge Article number is displayed.
- Article is related to the parent incident.
- Article contains the required incident/solution information.

Expected Result

A new **IT Knowledge Article** is successfully created from the resolved incident. The article is available for future troubleshooting and can help support agents resolve similar **Corporate VPN** issues efficiently.

Screenshot:

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow 'Service Operations Workspace' interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'List', 'Details', and 'CHG0030002'. The main header shows the incident title 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office' with buttons for 'Save', 'Request approval', and 'Assign to me'. Below the header, a progress bar indicates the incident's lifecycle stages: 1. New, 2. Assess, 3. Authorize, 4. Scheduled, 5. Implement, 6. Review, 7. Closed, and 8. Canceled. The 'Summary' section includes a short description, a detailed description, and a justification. The 'Scope and impact' and 'Assignment' sections are also visible. On the right, the 'Record information' panel shows the last update by David Loo and the 'Assigned to' field, which currently has no assignee.



Phase 12: Final Validation

Final Validation

Objective

The final validation confirms that all major activities in the **Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow** project have been completed successfully.

The parent incident, child incident, change request, Knowledge Article, and SLA information are checked to make sure that all related records and lifecycle activities are properly connected.

Final Validation is the last step of the **Incident Lifecycle Automation** project. In this phase, we verify that the complete incident lifecycle has been successfully completed and that all related records, activities, and integrations are working correctly.

1. Verify Parent Incident State

1. Open the **Parent Incident**.
2. Check the **State** field.
3. Verify that the state is:

Resolved

Expected Data

Field	Expected Value
Parent Incident	VPN Incident
State	Resolved

This confirms that the main incident has been successfully resolved.

Screenshot:

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow incident management interface. At the top, the navigation bar shows 'Service Operations Workspace'. The incident details for 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office' are visible, including its impact (3 - Low), state (New), and configuration item (PowerEdge T110 II). The lifecycle progress bar indicates the incident is currently in the 'New' state. The 'Record information' panel on the right shows that the incident has not yet been assigned and was requested by David Loo.

2. Verify Child Incident State

1. Open the Parent Incident.
2. Go to **Related Records**.

3. Open **Child Incidents**.
4. Open the created child incident.
5. Check the **State** field.
6. Verify that it is:

Resolved

Expected Data

Field	Expected Value
Child Incident	Unable to connect to Corporate VPN
State	Resolved

This confirms that the related child incident has also been completed.

Screenshot:

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow interface for a child incident. The incident title is "Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office". The state is "New" and the impact is "3 - Low". The configuration item is "PowerEdge T110 II". The workflow steps are: 1. New, 2. Assess, 3. Authorize, 4. Scheduled, 5. Implement, 6. Review, 7. Closed, 8. Canceled. The summary section includes a short description, a detailed description of the issue, and a justification for resolution. The right sidebar shows record information, including the assigned user (David Loo) and the requested by (David Loo).

3. Verify Activity Shows Resolution Triggered by Parent

1. Return to the **Parent Incident**.
2. Open the **Activity** section.
3. Review the activity history.
4. Verify that the activity shows the resolution action related to the **parent incident**.

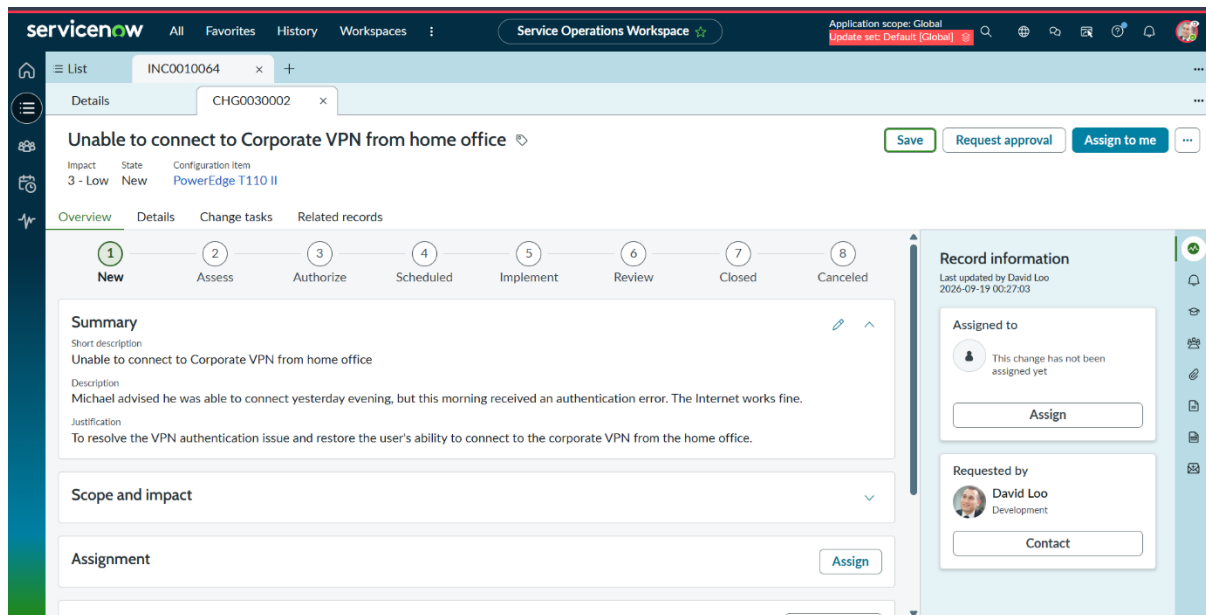
The Activity section provides a chronological record of actions performed on the incident.

Expected Data

Activity: Resolution triggered by Parent

This confirms that the parent-child incident relationship and resolution process worked correctly.

Screenshot:



4. Verify Change Request is Linked

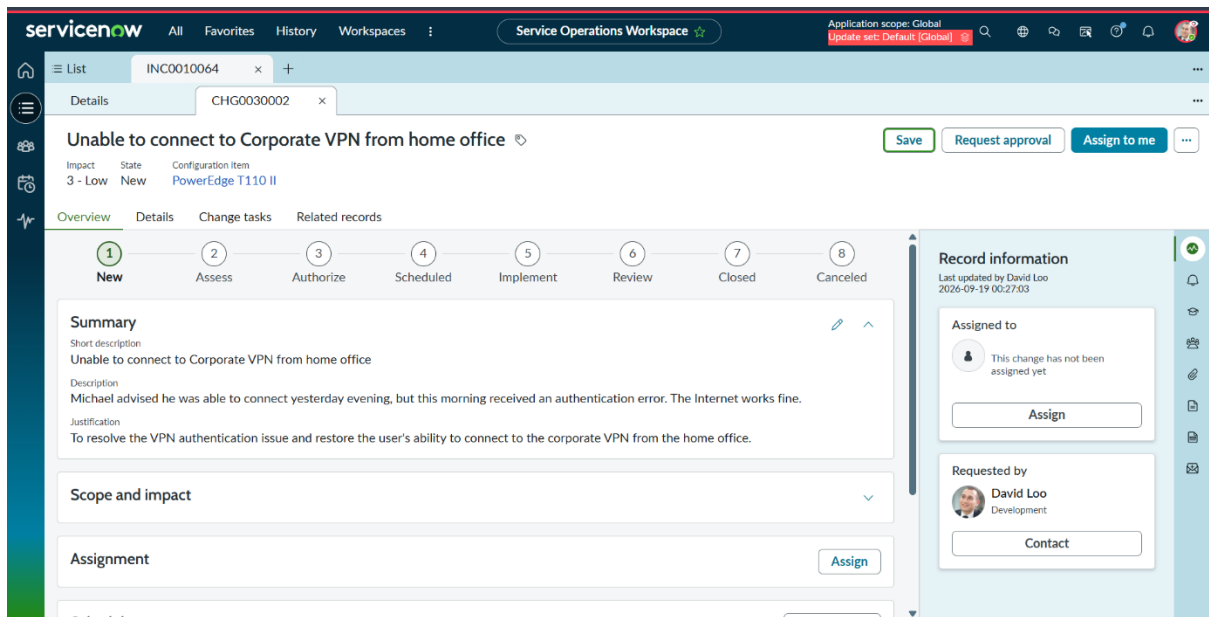
1. Open the Parent Incident.
2. Go to **Related Records**.
3. Locate the **Change Requests** section.
4. Verify that the emergency change request is listed.
5. Open the change request if required.
6. Verify that it is associated with the incident.

Expected Data

Item	Expected Value
Change Request	Emergency Change Request
Relationship	Linked to Parent Incident
Purpose	Required change for VPN service resolution

The linked change request provides a record of the change that was required to resolve the incident.

Screenshot:



5. Verify Knowledge Article is Created

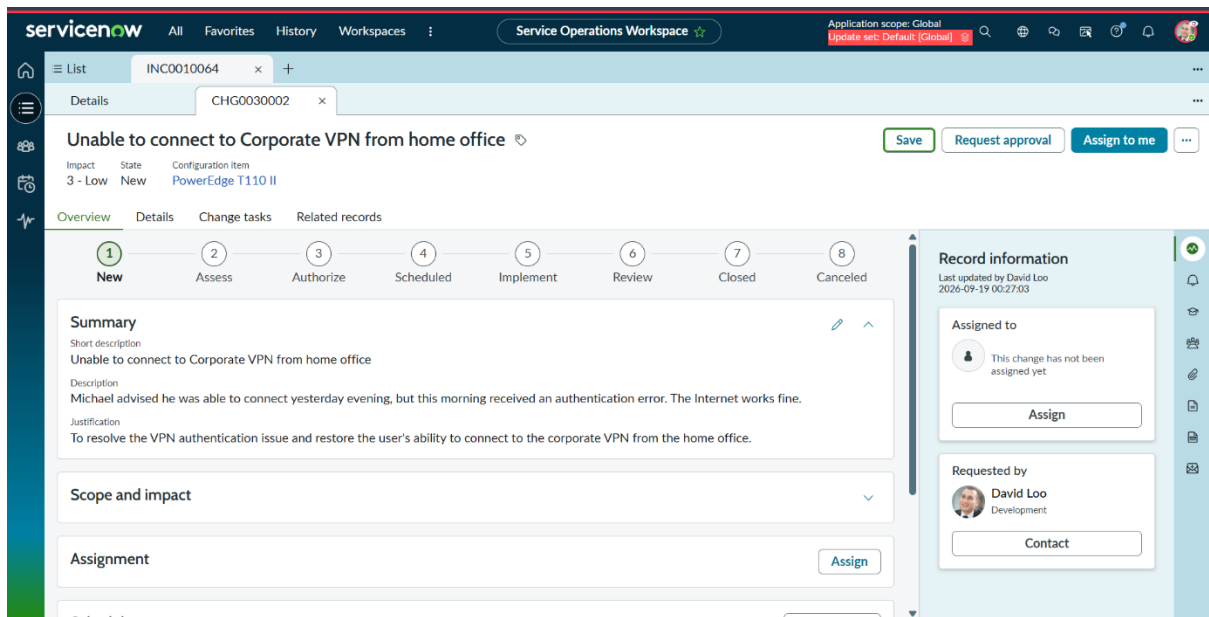
1. Return to the Parent Incident.
2. Open **Related Records**.
3. Locate **Created Knowledge**.
4. Verify that the Knowledge Article is listed.
5. Open the article if required.
6. Verify that the article contains the relevant incident and resolution information.

Expected Data

Field	Expected Value
Knowledge Base	IT
Template	Standard
Knowledge Article	Created Successfully
Related Record	Parent Incident

This confirms that the incident resolution has been converted into reusable knowledge.

Screenshot:



6. Verify SLA Tracking

1. Open the Parent Incident.
2. Go to **Related Records**.
3. Locate **Task SLAs**.
4. Verify that the SLA record is visible.
5. Check the SLA information such as:
 - SLA name
 - Stage
 - Start time
 - End time
 - Duration
 - Percentage/time remaining, depending on your instance configuration

Expected Data

Item	Expected Result
Task SLAs	Visible
Incident SLA	Tracked

Item	Expected Result
SLA Information	Available

This confirms that ServiceNow is tracking the incident against its defined Service Level Agreement.

Screenshot:

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow user interface. At the top, the navigation bar includes 'All', 'Favorites', 'History', and 'Workspaces'. The main header shows 'Service Operations Workspace'. Below this, the incident details are visible for 'INC0010064' with a sub-tab for 'CHG0030002'. The incident title is 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office'. The status is 'New' and the priority is '3 - Low'. The configuration item is 'PowerEdge T110 II'. A progress bar at the top of the main content area shows stages from 'New' to 'Canceled'. The 'Summary' section contains the short description 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office', a detailed description of the issue, and a justification for the change. The 'Scope and impact' and 'Assignment' sections are also visible. On the right side, the 'Record information' panel shows the last update by David Loo and the 'Assigned to' field, which currently has no assignee.

Final Project Data

Parent Incident

Short Description:

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Caller:

Michael Hoefer

Category:

Network

Subcategory:

VPN

Urgency:

2 - Medium

Service:

Remote Access

Service Offering:

Corporate VPN

Configuration Item:

PowerEdge

State:

Resolved

Probable Cause:

PowerEdge service was suspended and required restart.

Resolution Code:

Workaround provided

Resolution Notes:

Restarted VPN-SRV-02 service as per emergency change request.

Child Incident**Short Description:**

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN

Description:

User receiving VPN authentication failure error.

State:

Resolved

Relationship:

Linked to Parent Incident

Change Request**Type:**

Emergency Change Request

Relationship:

Linked to Parent Incident

Purpose:

Required change to support resolution of the VPN issue.

Knowledge Article**Knowledge Base:**

IT

Template:

Standard

Status:

Created Successfully

Relationship:

Created from / linked to Parent Incident

SLA**Task SLA:**

Visible under **Related Records → Task SLAs**

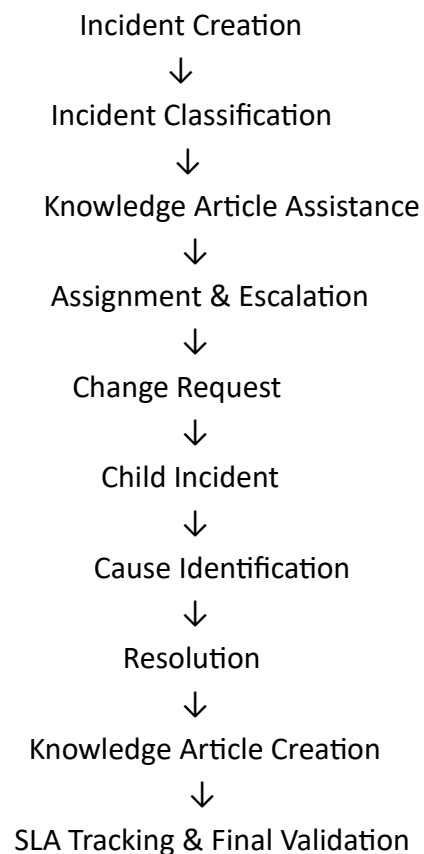
Status:

SLA tracking available

Overall Project Result

The **Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow** workflow has been successfully validated.

The complete lifecycle is:

**Final Outcome**

The project demonstrates that ServiceNow can manage an incident from **creation to resolution**, while maintaining related **child incidents, change requests, Knowledge Articles, and SLA tracking**.

Final Screenshot Caption:

This screenshot shows the 'Task SLAs' tab for incident INC0010064. The incident title is 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office'. The left sidebar lists various related records, with 'Task SLAs (4)' selected. The main content area displays a table of four task SLAs. The right sidebar shows 'Record Information' and 'Caller' details for Michael Hoefer.

SLA definition	Target	Stage	Actual time left	Business time left
Priority 5 response (40 hours)	Response	Completed	6 Days 11 Hours 58 Minutes	1 Day 16 Hours
Priority 4 resolution (2 day)	Resolution	Paused	9 Days 10 Hours 45 Minutes	2 Days
Network group resolution	Resolution	Paused	3 Hours 52 Minutes	3 Hours 52 Minutes
Priority 4 response (8 hours)	Response	Completed	2 Days 15 Hours 50 Minutes	8 Hours

This screenshot shows the 'Affected CIs' tab for the same incident. The left sidebar now has 'Affected CIs (1)' selected. The main content area displays a table with one row of configuration item data. The right sidebar remains the same, showing 'Record Information' and 'Caller' details.

☐	Configuration Item	Class	Support group	Owned by	Added From Dynamic CI
☐	PowerEdge T110 II	Computer	(empty)	(empty)	(empty)

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Service Operations Workspace Application scope: Global Update set: Default (Global)

INC0010064 x +

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Save Create change request Close Reopen

Overview Details Related records

Task SLAs (4)
Affected CIs (1)
Impacted Services/CIs (1)
Child Incidents (1)
Attached Knowledge (2)
Created Knowledge (1)
Change Requests (1)
Outages (0)
Affected Locations (0)

Impacted Services/CIs 1

Last refreshed just now.

	Configuration Item	Class	Support group	Owned by	Manually added
☐	Remote Access	Service	(empty)	(empty)	true

Showing 1-1 of 1 1 20 rows per page

Record Information

Last updated by David Loo
2026-09-19 00:14:40

SLAs and timings
Response SLA Completed Resolution SLA Paused
[View all SLAs](#)

Caller
MH Michael Hoefer
Development
Brasilia - 00:55:58
America/Los_Angeles
[Contact](#)

[Recent Incidents](#)
[Recent Interactions](#)
[Assigned assets](#)

Assigned to

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Service Operations Workspace Application scope: Global Update set: Default (Global)

INC0010064 x +

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Save Create change request Close Reopen

Overview Details Related records

Task SLAs (4)
Affected CIs (1)
Impacted Services/CIs (1)
Child Incidents (1)
Attached Knowledge (2)
Created Knowledge (1)
Change Requests (1)
Outages (0)
Affected Locations (0)

Child Incidents 1

Last refreshed just now.

[change_request](#)

	Number	Short description	Caller	Category	Service
☐	INC0010067	Unable to connect to Corporate VPN	Aileen Mottern	Inquiry / Help	(empty)

Showing 1-1 of 1 1 20 rows per page

Record Information

Last updated by David Loo
2026-09-19 00:14:40

SLAs and timings
Response SLA Completed Resolution SLA Paused
[View all SLAs](#)

Caller
MH Michael Hoefer
Development
Brasilia - 00:56:27
America/Los_Angeles
[Contact](#)

[Recent Incidents](#)
[Recent Interactions](#)
[Assigned assets](#)

Assigned to

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Service Operations Workspace Application scope: Global Update set: Default (Global)

INC0010064 x +

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office Save Create change request Close Reopen

Overview Details Related records

Task SLAs (4)
Affected CIs (1)
Impacted Services/CIs (1)
Child Incidents (1)
Attached Knowledge (2)
Created Knowledge (1)
Change Requests (1)
Outages (0)
Affected Locations (0)

Attached Knowledge 2
Last refreshed just now.

	Knowledge article	Short description	Knowledge base	Published
☐	change_request			
☐	KB0010004 v0.01	Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office	IT	
☐	KB0000008 v1.0	How to configure VPN for Apple Devices	IT	2014-09-10

Showing 1-2 of 2 20 rows per page

Record Information
Last updated by David Loo
2026-09-19 00:14:40

SLAs and timings
Response SLA Completed Resolution SLA Paused
[View all SLAs](#)

Caller
MH **Michael Hoefer**
Development
Brasilia - 00:56:55
America/Los_Angeles
[Contact](#)

[Recent incidents](#) >
[Recent interactions](#) >
[Assigned assets](#) >

Assigned to

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Service Operations Workspace Application scope: Global Update set: Default (Global)

INC0010064 x +

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office Save Create change request Close Reopen

Overview Details Related records

Task SLAs (4)
Affected CIs (1)
Impacted Services/CIs (1)
Child Incidents (1)
Attached Knowledge (2)
Created Knowledge (1)
Change Requests (1)
Outages (0)
Affected Locations (0)

Child Incidents 1
Last refreshed just now.

	Number	Short description	Caller	Category	Service
☐	INC0010067	Unable to connect to Corporate VPN	Aileen Mottern	Inquiry / Help	(empty)

Showing 1-1 of 1 20 rows per page

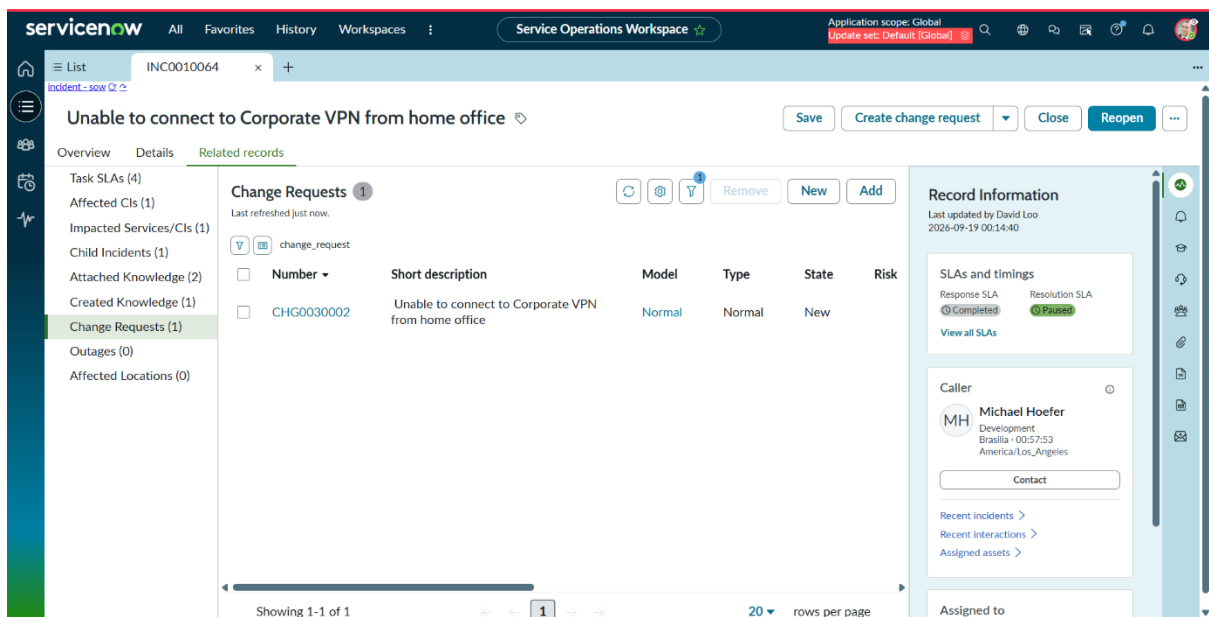
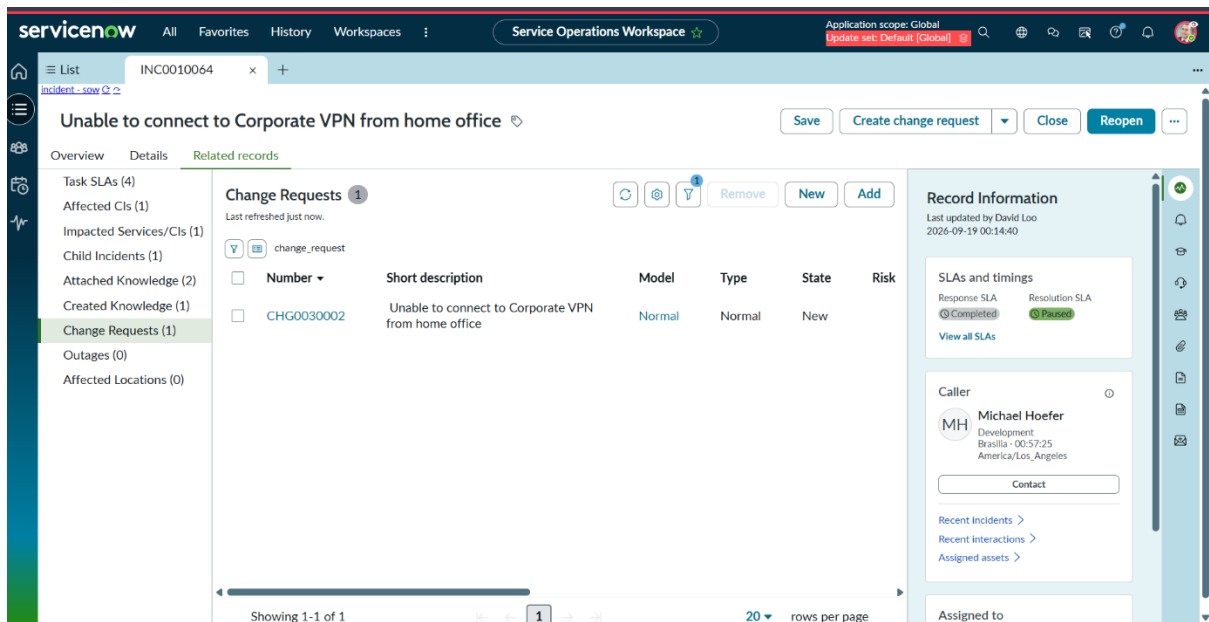
Record Information
Last updated by David Loo
2026-09-19 00:14:40

SLAs and timings
Response SLA Completed Resolution SLA Paused
[View all SLAs](#)

Caller
MH **Michael Hoefer**
Development
Brasilia - 00:56:27
America/Los_Angeles
[Contact](#)

[Recent incidents](#) >
[Recent interactions](#) >
[Assigned assets](#) >

Assigned to



Phase 13: Testing & Deployment Validation

Testing & Deployment Validation

1. Objective

The objective of Testing and Deployment Validation is to verify that the **Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow** project works correctly from incident creation to final resolution.

The testing confirms that:

- Incident lifecycle works end-to-end.
- Incidents can be escalated to the correct support team.

- Change requests can be connected to incidents.
- Child incidents can be created and managed.
- Knowledge Articles can be created from resolved incidents.
- SLA tracking is available.
- Multiple support teams can collaborate successfully.

2. Testing Validation

Each major functionality of the project was tested using the VPN incident scenario.

Test Case 1: Incident Creation

Test: Create a new incident for the Corporate VPN issue.

Expected Result:

A new incident is created successfully with a unique Incident Number.

Actual Result:

Incident was created successfully.

Test Case 2: Incident Classification

Test: Update the incident with the required classification information.

Test Data:

Field	Value
Category	Network
Subcategory	VPN
Urgency	2 - Medium
Service	Remote Access
Service Offering	Corporate VPN

Configuration Item PowerEdge

Expected Result:

Incident contains the correct classification information.

Test Case 3: Knowledge Integration

Test: Open Agent Assist and search for relevant Knowledge Articles.

Expected Result:

- Relevant Knowledge Articles are displayed.
- Article can be opened.
- Article can be marked as Helpful.
- Article can be attached to the incident.

Actual Result:

Knowledge Article was successfully attached to the incident.

Test Case 4: Escalation

Test: Reassign the incident to the appropriate support team.

Expected Result:

Incident is successfully assigned to the required support group.

Actual Result:

Incident was successfully reassigned for specialized support.

Test Case 5: Change Integration

Test: Create/link an emergency change request related to the incident.

Expected Result:

Change request is successfully linked to the parent incident.

Actual Result:

Change request relationship was verified under Related Records.

Test Case 6: Child Incident Management

Test: Create a child incident from the parent incident.

Test Data:

Short Description:

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN

Description:

User receiving VPN authentication failure error.

Expected Result:

Child incident is created and displayed under:

Parent Incident → Related Records → Child Incidents

Actual Result:

Child incident was successfully created and linked to the parent incident.

Test Case 7: Probable Cause

Test: Add the probable cause to the incident.

Test Data:

PowerEdge service was suspended and required restart.

Expected Result:

Probable cause is saved successfully.

Actual Result:

Probable cause was successfully recorded.

Test Case 8: Incident Resolution

Test: Add resolution details and resolve the incident.

Resolution Code:

Workaround provided

Resolution Notes:

Restarted VPN-SRV-02 service as per emergency change request.

Expected Result:

Incident changes to **Resolved**.

Actual Result:

Parent incident was successfully resolved.

Test Case 9: Knowledge Article Creation

Test: Create a Knowledge Article from the resolved incident.

Test Data:

Field	Value
Knowledge Base	IT
Template	Standard

Expected Result:

Knowledge Article is created and appears under:

Related Records → Created Knowledge

Actual Result:

Knowledge Article was successfully created and verified.

Test Case 10: SLA Tracking

Test: Verify SLA information for the incident.

Expected Result:

SLA information is visible under:

Related Records → Task SLAs

Actual Result:

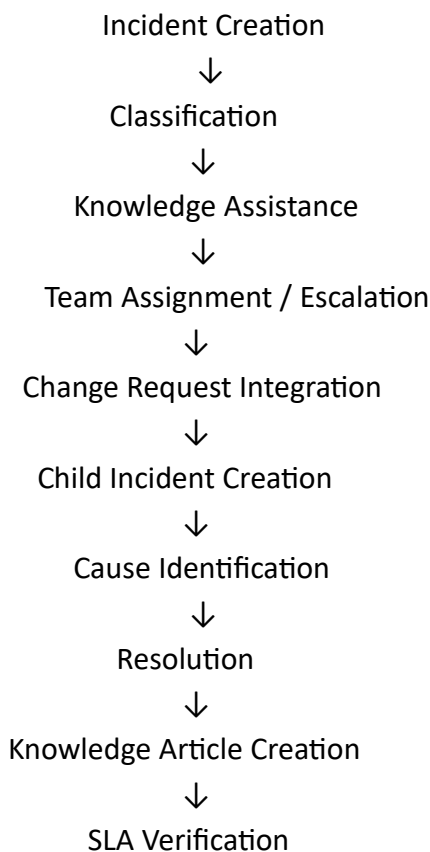
SLA tracking was successfully verified.

3. End-to-End Testing

The complete incident lifecycle was tested from beginning to end.

End-to-end testing was performed to verify the complete **Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow** workflow from incident creation to final resolution.

The testing started by creating a new incident for the **Corporate VPN** issue. The incident was classified with the required category, subcategory, urgency, service, service offering, and Configuration Item. Knowledge Articles were then searched and attached using Agent Assist to support faster troubleshooting.

Tested Flow**4. Multi-Team Collaboration Validation**

The scenario was also tested from a collaboration perspective.

The project was tested to verify that multiple teams can collaborate effectively during the Incident Management lifecycle.

The **Service Desk Team** creates and classifies the incident and assigns it to the appropriate support group. The **Level 2 Support Team** investigates the technical issue and works on the required resolution. When an emergency change is required, the **Change Management Team** handles the change request and maintains the change record.

After the issue is resolved, the resolution details are documented and a **Knowledge Article** is created so that Service Desk agents can reuse the solution for similar incidents in the future.

Different teams participate in the incident lifecycle:

Team / Role	Responsibility
Service Desk	Create and classify incident
Network Team	Investigate VPN issue
Level 2 Support	Perform technical troubleshooting
Change Management	Handle emergency change
Knowledge Management	Create reusable Knowledge Article

ServiceNow Administrator Maintain configuration and workflow

Expected Result

Each team can perform its required activity while the incident and related records remain connected.

5. Deployment Validation

Before considering the project ready for deployment, the following items should be checked.

Configuration Validation

- Incident configuration is working correctly.
- Assignment Groups are available.
- Required users are available.
- Services and Service Offerings are configured.
- Configuration Items are available.
- Knowledge Base and Standard template are available.
- Change Request functionality is available.

- Child Incident functionality is available.
- SLA tracking is enabled.

6. User Acceptance Validation

User Acceptance Validation was performed to confirm that the Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow meets the expected business and functional requirements.

The complete incident process was reviewed from the perspective of Service Desk agents and support teams. Users verified that they could create and classify incidents, assign incidents to the appropriate support team, use Knowledge Articles, create child incidents, link change requests, record resolution details, and track SLAs. The following activities were validated:

- Incident creation and classification
- Incident assignment and escalation
- Knowledge Article search and attachment
- Child Incident creation and tracking
- Change Request integration
- Probable cause and resolution documentation
- Incident resolution
- Knowledge Article creation
- SLA tracking
- Multi-team collaboration

The complete workflow should be reviewed from the perspective of the Service Desk and support teams.

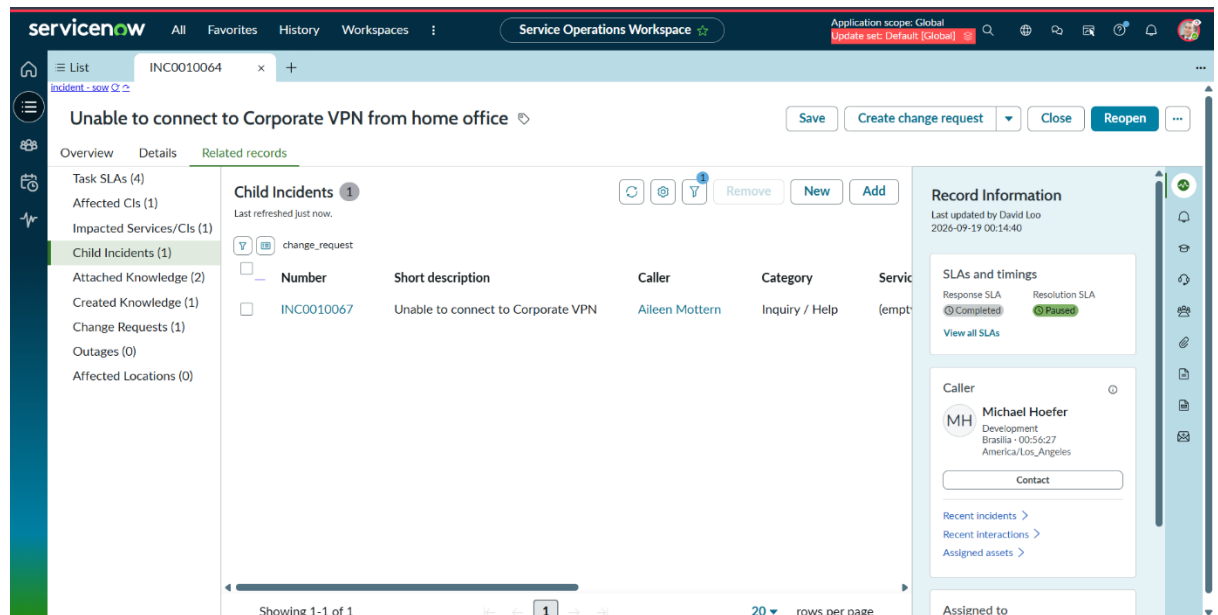
8. Final Deployment Validation

The **Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow** project successfully demonstrates an end-to-end incident management process.

The solution validates:

1. **Incident Lifecycle End-to-End** – Incident creation through resolution was successfully tested.
2. **Escalation Process** – Incidents can be transferred to specialized support teams.
3. **Change Integration** – Emergency change requests can be associated with incidents.
4. **Knowledge Creation** – Resolved incidents can be converted into reusable Knowledge Articles.
5. **Child Incident Management** – Related issues can be tracked through child incidents.
6. **SLA Tracking** – Incident SLA information is available through Task SLAs.

7. **Multi-Team Collaboration** – Service Desk, Network, Change Management, and Knowledge teams can work together.
8. **Screenshot Caption:**



Phase 14: Conclusion

Conclusion

The **Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow** project successfully demonstrates an end-to-end Incident Management process.

The project provides a structured approach to **creating, classifying, assigning, escalating, resolving, and tracking incidents**. Service Desk agents can use Knowledge Articles to identify solutions faster, while Level 2 support teams can investigate and resolve technical issues.

The integration between **Incident Management, Change Management, and Knowledge Management** helps maintain proper relationships between incidents, change requests, child incidents, and Knowledge Articles. SLA tracking also helps monitor service performance and supports timely incident resolution.

Overall, this project improves **incident visibility, team collaboration, knowledge reuse, SLA adherence, and IT service delivery**. It demonstrates how ServiceNow can automate and standardize the complete incident lifecycle while maintaining proper documentation and traceability.

Final Outcome

The project successfully validates:

- End-to-end Incident Management
- Incident classification and escalation

- Change Request integration
- Child Incident management
- Knowledge Article creation
- SLA tracking
- Multi-team collaboration
- Proper incident resolution and documentation

Therefore, the project provides an efficient, organized, and scalable approach to managing IT incidents using ServiceNow.

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow user interface for a specific incident record. The top navigation bar includes 'All', 'Favorites', 'History', and 'Workspaces', with the current workspace being 'Service Operations Workspace'. The incident ID 'INC0010064' is visible in the header. The incident title is 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office'. Below the title, there are tabs for 'Overview', 'Details', and 'Related records'. The 'Related records' tab is active, showing a list of 'Change Requests'. The list contains one entry with the number 'CHG0030002' and the description 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office'. The table columns are 'Number', 'Short description', 'Model', 'Type', 'State', and 'Risk'. To the right of the table, there is a 'Record Information' panel showing the caller 'Michael Hoefer' and the status 'Completed'. The bottom of the interface shows pagination information: 'Showing 1-1 of 1' and '20 rows per page'.